



Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations

D2.TTG.CL3.15

Trainee Manual



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Trainee Manual



Specialist centre
for foods, tourism
& hospitality



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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainee chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service
- Front Office

- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations in a range of settings within the travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D2.TTG.CL3.15

Nominal Hours:

80

Element 1: Plan minimal impact operations

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Identify the proposed activity/operation to be conducted
- 1.2 Identify the location in which the identified activity/operation is proposed to be conducted
- 1.3 Research the factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity
- 1.4 Research the compliance requirements that apply to the proposed activity/operation and location
- 1.5 Develop a plan that details the experiences and activities to be implemented

Element 2: Trial minimal impact operations

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Organise for the trial to be conducted
- 2.2 Conduct the trial operation as planned
- 2.3 Monitor the impacts of the trial
- 2.4 Evaluate the information generated by the trial
- 2.5 Utilise the information from the trial to modify previous plans so as to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts

Element 3: Implement minimal impact operations

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Apply revised plans to the practical application of minimal impact tourism activities/operations
- 3.2 Conduct the activity/operation in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions
- 3.3 Implement ongoing monitoring protocols

Element 4: Evaluate minimal impact operations

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Collect objective environmental data
- 4.2 Solicit feedback from the local community and staff
- 4.3 Collaborate with local authorities to manage local environmental and social issues caused by, or related to, the minimal impact activity/operation
- 4.4 Modify previous plans on the basis of valid data obtained

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Plan minimal impact operations				
1.1	Identify the proposed activity/operation to be conducted	1.1	1, 2	1
1.2	Identify the location in which the identified activity/operation is proposed to be conducted	1.1	3, 4, 5	2
1.3	Research the factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity	1.1	6 – 11	3
1.4	Research the compliance requirements that apply to the proposed activity/operation and location	1.1	12	4
1.5	Develop a plan that details the experiences and activities to be implemented	1.1	13, 14, 15	5
Element 2: Trial minimal impact operations				
2.1	Organise for the trial to be conducted	2.1	16 – 19	6
2.2	Conduct the trial operation as planned	2.1	20	7
2.3	Monitor the impacts of the trial	2.1	21, 22	8
2.4	Evaluate the information generated by the trial	2.1	23 – 28	9
2.5	Utilise the information from the trial to modify previous plans so as to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts	2.1	29, 30, 31	10

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 3: Implement minimal impact operations				
3.1	Apply revised plans to the practical application of minimal impact tourism activities/operations	3.1	32	11
3.2	Conduct the activity/operation in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions	3.1	33, 34	12
3.3	Implement ongoing monitoring protocols	3.1	35	13
Element 4: Evaluate minimal impact operations				
4.1	Collect objective environmental data	4.1	36 – 40	14
4.2	Solicit feedback from the local community and staff	4.1	41	15
4.3	Collaborate with local authorities to manage local environmental and social issues caused by, or related to, the minimal impact activity/operation	4.1	42, 43, 44	16
4.4	Modify previous plans on the basis of valid data obtained	4.1	45, 46	17

Glossary

Term	Explanation
AC	ASEAN Community
APEC	Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation
ASEAN	Association of Southeast Asian Nations
ATSP	ASEAN Tourism Strategic Plan
COP	Code of Practice
F&B	Food and Beverage
Fauna	Animals and wildlife
Flora	Plants and flowers
GPS	Global Positioning System
Hard copy	Paper-based copy
ICT	Information and Communications Technology
Inclusion	Something included as part of the tour – such as a side trip, meals, accommodation, tour bag, travel
Itinerary	A schedule for a tour showing what tour group members will be doing, where they will be going, and the times for each activity
PATA	Pacific Asia Travel Association
ROI	Return On Investment
Soft copy	Electronic version of a document
UNEP	United Nations Environment Programme
WTO	World Tourism Organisation
Qualitative data	Information on people's thoughts, opinions and feelings
Quantitative data	Statistical and fact-based information

Element 1:

Plan minimal impact operations

1.1 Identify the proposed activity/operation to be conducted

Introduction

Tourism that has minimum impact has become an important consideration and fundamental aim for most tourism operators

This section introduces the concept of minimal impact tourism operations and presents examples of activities which may need to be considered as part of the planning process.



Minimal impact tourism is sustainable tourism

There is no single, universally-agreed definition of minimal impact tourism.

In practice, it is known more commonly as 'sustainable tourism'.

It may also be referred to by other terms such as:

- Green tourism
- Responsible tourism
- Eco-tourism
- Environmental tourism
- Ethical tourism.

Tourism Australia states:

'Sustainability is just one word and yet there exists over 300 definitions. The best-known definition of sustainability or sustainable development comes from the World Commission on Environment and Development and is outlined as: "forms of progress that meet the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their needs."'

(Source: <http://www.tourism.australia.com/industry-advice/what-is-sustainability.aspx>)

Critical in the notion are Tourism Operators taking action to:

- Avoid damage to the area visited
- Minimise impact on the area visited
- Repair previous damage.

Websites

For further discussion on 'sustainable tourism' and what it entails and how it may be defined visit:

http://www.iztg.hr/en/odrzivi_razvoj/sustainable_tourism/ - What is sustainable tourism

http://www.unesco.org/education/tlsf/mods/theme_c/mod16.html - Sustainable tourism

<http://www.sustainabletourism.net/> - Sustaining tourism



ASEAN commitment to Sustainable Tourism

The ASEAN Tourism Strategic Plan (ATSP) 2011- 2015 states as its Vision:

“By 2015, ASEAN will provide an increasing number of visitors to the region with authentic and diverse products, enhanced connectivity, a safe and secure environment, increased quality of services, while at the same time ensuring an increased quality of life and opportunities for residents through responsible and sustainable tourism development by working effectively with a wide range of stakeholders”

Emphasising:

“All strategic directions and actions in the ATSP are guided by responsible and sustainable tourism principles recognizing the significant role that tourism plays in poverty reduction, climate change, gender and minority issues, capacity building, cultural preservation and natural conservation.”

(Source:

http://www.buinesseventsthailand.com/fileadmin/user_upload/documents/mice-publications/Asean_Travel_Tourism.pdf)

Industry commitment

In addition to ASEAN's commitment, the commitment to sustainable tourism by the wider industry can be seen in the APEC/PATA Code for Sustainable Tourism (see http://www.gdrc.org/uem/eco-tour/apec_pata-code.html) which affirms its stance:

“... to encourage and assist in the development of travel industries throughout Pacific-Asia in a manner which recognises the urgent importance to practice an environmental ethic that supports responsible conservation and restoration of Pacific Asia's unique combination of natural, social and cultural resources”.

A further range of excerpts from this Code is presented in section 1.4.

Responsible Tour Operator action

Within the construct of minimal impact/sustainable tourism described above, individual Tourism Operators can demonstrate responsible practice by planning and trialling tourism operations for minimal impact before implementing them as standard practice in their business.

The first step in this process is the need to identify proposed activities or operations to be conducted so they can be:

- Properly described and quantified
- Geographically located
- Researched to determine the factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity
- Analysed to identify relevant compliance requirements that need to be met
- Properly planned with reference to a suitable and detailed, written proposal and plan of action.



Examples of activities which may need to be planned

Proposed tourism activities/operations which may be addressed in a sustainable or minimal impact manner can be related to:

- Constructing facilities – such as:
 - Access roads
 - Buildings
 - Infrastructure
- Introducing tours – into areas where there was previously no tours
- Increasing the tourist footprint – in terms of, for example:
 - Bringing in more visitors
 - Increasing the number of tours to the area
 - Increasing the duration of tours
- Introducing interpretive activities – which may require:
 - Access to new/different areas
 - Use of local resources
 - Involvement of local communities
- Establishing camps – for over-night and/or longer stays where there will be a demand for:
 - Toilet and washing facilities
 - Cooking and eating facilities
- Interacting with wildlife – as:
 - Part of a tour
 - Caused by tourist intrusion (camps; travel through regions) into their natural habitat.

1.2 Identify the location in which the identified activity/operation is proposed to be conducted

Introduction

All proposed tourism activities need to be geographically located in order to physically position where the operations are to occur.

This section discusses a range of factors inherent in this basic, initial phase of the planning process.



Locating the activity/operation

Identifying the location of the tourism activity or operation refers to:

- Describing the immediate geographic vicinity in which the activity/operation itself is proposed – which may occur with reference to:
 - Specific latitudinal and longitudinal points
 - Name of country/countries
 - Local (recognised or generally accepted and understood) names –for towns, villages, communities, areas, regions, locales and/or points of interest
 - Geographic features – such as mountains, rivers, lakes, coastlines, islands and other prominent landforms
- Stating associated geographic locations that may be impacted by the activity/operation – which may require specification of:
 - Camp sites not intrinsic to the proposed tour activity
 - Position of supporting facilities – such as parking and loading/unloading areas, airfields/landing areas, storage space for permanent plant and equipment, infrastructure
 - Routes that will enable access (ingress and egress) to the activity/operation – including details of land, water and air travel.

Need to identify location/s

The exact location/s for proposed tourism activities and operations need to be correctly and specifically determined in order to:

- Demonstrate transparency and openness in the proposal – which is an essential pre-requisite for generating genuine support and positive commitment to the initiative from all stakeholders
- Ensure all those potentially impacted can be made aware of the proposal – and make whatever input or comment they believe is appropriate and relevant
- Make sure the correct/necessary people (communities, locals, government agencies) are involved – and can be involved in the planning and subsequent stages
- Begin the process of researching government funding which may be available for the area – to support sustainable/minimal impact tourism initiatives

- Research standard factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity – more on this is presented in section 1.3 but standard classification of these factors include:
 - Environmental
 - Socio-cultural
 - Economic
- Identify the country/countries involved – as this will have significant importance regarding legislation and local requirements which need to be accommodated: more on this is presented in section 1.4
- Start the process of identifying other Tourism Operators who may be operating in the area – to help determine the *cumulative* impact/total of all tours and tourists to the area
- Enable identification of other non-legislated requirements which apply – in terms of (for example) existing industry Codes of Practice (COP), government plans, commercial agreements negotiated with local communities (see also section 1.4)
- Provide a real-world context for the written plan which will be prepared – see section 1.5.

Ways to identify location/s

A combination of the following is used to define the location of the proposed activity/operation:

- Visit the site/area – ensuring:
 - Notes are taken to describe required and/or preferred locations
 - GPS technology is used to record points
- Talk to locals – to:
 - Identify local names
 - Initiate contact and relationship building
 - Find out other tours/activities already being conducted
- Speak to industry bodies – to:
 - Obtain applicable Codes
 - Obtain relevant reports and/or research on the area
- Liaise with government agencies – to:
 - Obtain information they have on the proposal/site
 - Determine their orientation to the proposed activity
 - Obtain copies of applicable legislation
- Use of suitably detailed maps – commonly a combination of:
 - General reference maps
 - Topographic maps.



1.3 Research the factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity

Introduction

When the type and geographic location of a proposed activity has been identified the next step in the planning process is to research the factors that may be impacted by the proposal.

This section examines the standard range of factors which are accepted as being potentially impacted by a tourist activity/operation.

Context for this discussion

It is essential to understand:

- It is one of the fundamental tenets underpinning acceptance of minimal impact tourism that all tourism activity has *some* impact – no initiative in this regard is ever *totally* free of impact
- The number and extent of the impact can and will vary between initiatives – meaning each proposed initiative needs to be researched on a case-by-case basis
- Previous, like initiatives can provide an indication of impacts of other similar initiatives – but the link is not necessarily a direct one
- Impacts can be positive or negative – a positive impact in one area/set of factors can also result in a negative impact in one or more other areas/sets of factors: the impact is not *always* unilaterally positive or negative for any given initiative
- There is often a lack of clarity and/or consensus about what the projected impacts of a minimal impact tourism initiative will be – despite consultation, debate and discussion there can be quite heated disagreement about the way research was done, assumptions which were made, stakeholders who were involved and the amount and type of consultation entered into
- Tourism Operators who subscribe to an industry Code relating to sustainable/minimal impact tourism development/operation are commonly required by that Code to research impact on these factors – as standard practice
- There is often a mandatory *external* requirement for research of this type to be undertaken – before a proposal can be approved by local communities, government agencies or industry bodies (and/or for funding).



Impact of tourism

It is accepted tourism generally impacts:

- The environment
- Society and culture
- The economy.

The United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) observes:

“On one hand, tourism yields tremendous economic positive outcomes: it is one of the world’s most significant sources of economic outcomes and employment. However, tourism is a very complex industry involving numerous stakeholders (sometimes with opposite interests) and requiring significant amount of resources. As such, tourism can have very opposite effects according to the way activities are managed. Managed well, tourism can play a positive role in the socio, cultural, economical, environmental and political development of the destination and as such represents a significant development opportunity for many countries and communities. On the contrary, unchecked tourism development can lead to very damageable impacts.”

(Source:

<http://www.unep.org/resourceefficiency/Business/SectoralActivities/Tourism/FactsandFiguresaboutTourism/ImpactsofTourism/tabid/78774/Default.aspx> - Impacts of tourism)

Carrying capacity

A sustainable tourism activity must consider the carrying capacity of the location.

The World Tourism Organisation (WTO) suggests carrying capacity can be defined as follows:

“The maximum number of people that may visit a tourist destination at the same time, without causing destruction of the physical, economic, socio-cultural environment and an unacceptable decrease in the quality of visitors' satisfaction.”

(Source:

http://www.biodiversity.ru/coastlearn/tourism-eng/con_capacity.html - Sustainable Tourism).



In addition it is useful to understand:

- “Ecological carrying capacity relates to the maximum use of a tourist resource without causing any harm to the environment
- Social carrying capacity relates to the reaction of the local people to the tourist development of the place, which should never be negative
- Psychological carrying capacity relates to the quality of visitors' satisfaction with a certain tourist destination, which is not to be decreased
- Economic carrying capacity relates to the level of acceptable dependence between the local economy and the level of the tourist development of a place, which should never become too heavy

The final carrying capacity of a tourist destination is a resultant of the four aforementioned types of carrying capacity that are all inter-dependable. However, sometimes they are completely opposite.”

(Source:

<http://www.google.com/url?sa=t&rct=j&q=&esrc=s&source=web&cd=3&ved=0CDcQFjAC&url=http%3A%2F%2Fwww.danubecc.org%2Fupl%2FE-learning%2520Modules%2FModule%25205%2520-%2520Tourism%2520carrying%2520capacity.doc&ei=fHvRvVbLyLZD98QWf-4OgAw&usg=AFQjCNHcxtceGSLuL43c7uLhc3MsiCptOQ&sig2=XNjpn4KWDS3PsUfn10Eobw&bvm=bv.94455598.d.dGc> – Module 5:Tourism carrying capacity.)

Environmental factors

These relate to how the activity/operation is likely to affect:

- The natural environment – which may include:
 - Possible air pollution – caused by vehicles and camp fires
 - Contamination of fresh water, sea water and drinking water – through litter and sewage
 - Degradation of the land and the landscape – as a result of vehicles, physical presence of tourists, tourism activities on-site, camping
 - Increased use of scarce local resources – such as fuel, drinking water
 - Greater levels of noise – caused by the extra vehicles, activities and people
 - Aesthetic pollution – simply caused by the presence of vehicles, people and man-made items in a pristine, natural environment
 - Increase in waste (litter and rubbish) generated by tourists and their presence/activities
- The built environment – in relation to the impact of extra people/tourists in relation to:
 - How their presence will affect the existing infrastructure – such as the impact of tourists coaches and vehicles on local roads; the impact of extra people at monument sites and in buildings (museums, public toilets, hospitals, transport hubs)
 - Need to build or provide new infrastructure and/or extra buildings – to cater for the proposed traffic (vehicular and pedestrian/foot)
- The ecology – and the impact of tourism on:
 - Animals and their habitat
 - Plants
 - Other organisms.



UNEP (at <http://www.unep.org/resourceefficiency/Home/Business/SectoralActivities/Tourism/WhyTourism/ImpactsofTourism/EnvironmentalImpacts/tabid/78775/Default.aspx>) states

“The quality of the environment, both natural and man-made, is essential to tourism. However, tourism's relationship with the environment is complex. It involves many activities that can have adverse environmental effects. Many of these impacts are linked with the construction of general infrastructure such as roads and airports, and of tourism facilities, including resorts, hotels, restaurants, shops, golf courses and marinas. The negative impacts of tourism development can gradually destroy the environmental resources on which it depends.

On the other hand, tourism has the potential to create beneficial effects on the environment by contributing to environmental protection and conservation. It is a way to raise awareness of environmental values and it can serve as a tool to finance protection of natural areas and increase their economic importance.”

Socio-cultural factors

Social factors relate to social dislocation and changes to existing social interactions within the local community.

Cultural factors relate to art, dance, music, story-telling, tools, implements, foods, artefacts, symbols, symbolic actions, rituals, rites, ceremonies, celebrations, heroes, significant figures, individuals, beliefs, assumptions, values, attitudes, language, religion, education, social institutions and cultural sites.



UNEP offers the following (at

<http://www.unep.org/resourceefficiency/Home/Business/SectoralActivities/Tourism/WhyTourism/ImpactsofTourism/SocioCulturalImpacts/tabid/78780/Default.aspx>) in relation to the socio-cultural impacts of tourism:

“The socio-cultural impacts of tourism described here are the effects on host communities of direct and indirect relations with tourists, and of interaction with the tourism industry. For a variety of reasons, host communities often are the weaker party in interactions with their guests and service providers, leveraging any influence they might have. These influences are not always apparent, as they are difficult to measure, depend on value judgments and are often indirect or hard to identify.

The impacts arise when tourism brings about changes in value systems and behaviour and thereby threatens indigenous identity. Furthermore, changes often occur in community structure, family relationships, collective traditional life styles, ceremonies and morality. But tourism can also generate positive impacts as it can serve as a supportive force for peace, foster pride in cultural traditions and help avoid urban relocation by creating local jobs. As often happens when different cultures meet, socio-cultural impacts are ambiguous: the same objectively described impacts are seen as beneficial by some groups, and are perceived as negative - or as having negative aspects - by other stakeholders.”

More specifically the social and cultural impacts of tourism can potentially include (based on information provided by UNEP in an article entitled ‘The negative socio-cultural impacts of tourism’):

- Commodification of a community/society – where their rituals and culture are converted into a ‘product’ to be sold, creating what they call a ‘reconstructed ethnicity’ which is altered for commercial purposes
- Standardisation – meaning the unique nature of a culture/society is standardised to meet the expectations of (some) tourists
- Loss of authenticity – as the people adapt to accommodate the actual or perceived needs of the tourists, producing sometimes what the UN refers to as ‘staged authenticity’
- Adaptation to tourist demands – as local communities focus on producing artefacts and items suited to the demands of tourists rather than their own needs

- Cultural clashes – where people from different cultures do not mix, perhaps based on:
 - Economic inequality between cultures/peoples
 - Irritation regarding the behaviour displayed by tourists while at the location
 - Job level friction – in that local people are often employed in lower level/lower paying jobs than other workers employed by the Tourism Operator



- Increase in crime rates – caused when locals steal from tourists
- Child labour
- Prostitution and sex tourism.

The article also makes the following point regarding local community engagement with tourists:

“The attitude of local residents towards tourism development may unfold through the stages of euphoria, where visitors are very welcome, through apathy, irritation and potentially antagonism, when anti-tourist attitudes begin growing among local people.”

(Source:

<http://www.unep.org/resourceefficiency/Business/SectoralActivities/Tourism/FactsandFiguresaboutTourism/ImpactsOfTourism/Socio-CulturalImpacts/NegativeSocio-CulturalImpactsFromTourism/tabid/78781/Default.aspx>)

Economic factors

In this context consideration of economic factors can be seen as relating to impacts on:

- Employment – and:
 - The number of jobs created – and the status of these jobs as measured by indicators (such as) number of hours per week, number of full-time jobs, number of part-time jobs, number of casual jobs or hours
 - The level of these jobs – in terms of whether they are permanently low-level positions or whether they allow for genuine career development
 - Conditions of employment provided by employers for the workers
- Investment – in terms of issues such as:
 - Infrastructure
 - Buildings
 - Training and development
 - Repairing damage to the environment
- Inflation – and how this affects:
 - Price of land and houses for locals – when Tourism operators purchase land and buildings: there may be a need to protect the interests of locals by limiting the amount, location or type of purchases which can be made by Tourism organisations
 - Cost of limited resources/raw materials – as these are bought for tourism purposes, they commonly become more expensive for locals so there may be a need to limit what can be purchased or to require Tourism Operators to carry in all the resources they want to use

- Local income – and how this:
 - Enables tangible benefits for the recipients – as defined by the relevant community (which may be in terms of housing acquisition; standard of living indicators; access to food, medical, education and/or other services)
 - Circulates throughout the local economy – known as the ‘multiplier effect’, economists believe money earned by one person in a community can circulate throughout the economy up to four times (as people spend that money within their community) bringing an economic benefit for four people not just the original one person
- Opportunity cost – meaning the money spent on tourism cannot be spent on something else which may have brought a larger benefit to the area/people
- The extent of the reliance on tourism-related income and the contribution made by tourism to regional development – in general:
 - Total dependence on tourism is seen as a bad thing – subject to seasonal influences, global trends, and rapid changes caused by external events
 - Partial reliance on tourism is regarded as a positive element of a wider economic plan.

UNEP have researched ‘Negative economic impacts of tourism’

(<http://www.unep.org/resourceefficiency/Business/SectoralActivities/Tourism/FactsandFigureaboutTourism/ImpactsofTourism/EconomicImpactsofTourism/NegativeEconomicImpactsofTourism/tabid/78784/Default.aspx>) and highlight there are potentially issues relating to:

- Leakage – which refers to the amount of money lost to a local community after all expenses to governments (taxes, levies, fees, charges) are paid, and after all payments to *external* organisations (the businesses who own the tour companies, hotels, transport companies, catering outlets) are made
- Enclave tourism – where tourists visit an area but spend most of their money in the one location (a hotel, cruise ship, resort) rather than spreading it around among local community people or smaller local businesses
- Infrastructure costs – where local governments are forced to pay the cost of building roads and providing support services (police, medical, tax relief for tourists) to enable tourism to function



The article also discusses negative impacts which have been identified in relation to:

- Increases in prices
- Economic dependence of the local community on tourism
- Seasonal character of jobs.

It concludes by saying:

“Economic crises, like the Asian crisis that hit Thailand, Malaysia and Indonesia a few years ago, can be devastating to inbound tourism flows. The financial turmoil triggered a sharp fall in tourism flows to affected countries during 1997 and 1998. In the Philippines, the crisis and the temporary closure of Philippine Airlines affected inbound arrivals significantly as there was a decline of almost 3.3% in 1998.”

Ways to conduct this research

Researching the factors likely to be impacted by a tourism initiative should involve a mix of the following strategies:

- Talk to those who have conducted similar operations in similar areas – to obtain their input
- Read reports on previous similar activities – many of these exist to provide data on other tourism initiatives

See, for example:

http://crctourism.com.au/wms/upload/resources/books/hop/3-3_socialimpacts_v01_web.pdf – Social impact of tourism on the Gold Coast

http://ijbssnet.com/journals/Vol_4_No_3_March_2013/2.pdf – Understanding the economic impact of tourism in the Asia Pacific region using the Tourism Satellite Account

<http://cdn.intechopen.com/pdfs-wm/35710.pdf> – A model for assessing the level of tourism impacts and sustainability of coastal cities

- Speak with local communities who have been the subject of previous activities
- Communicate with those expected to be impacted by the proposed activity
- Establish baseline data/benchmarks – to use as reference points for future monitoring and evaluation
- Visit the area – to gain first-hand experience of the location and meet face-to-face with the community and those who will/may be impacted.



Websites

It is recommended the following sites are also visited:

http://www.unep.org/10yfp/Portals/50150/downloads/Asia_Pacific_10YFP_Roadmap_2014_2015_FINAL.pdf - The 10 Year Framework of Programmes on Sustainable Consumption and Production (10YFP): Roadmap for the 10YFP implementation in Asia and the Pacific 2014 – 2015 with particular attention to Section C.1.D ‘Sustainable tourism including eco-tourism’

http://www.eucentre.sg/wp-content/uploads/2013/12/EUCResearchBrief_TourismEU27ASEAN.pdf - Tourism as a driver of economic growth and development in the EU-27 and ASEAN regions

<http://www.slideshare.net/reymarieoohlala/overview-of-tourism-impacts> - Overview of tourism impacts

<http://www.asean.org/resources/publications/asean-publications/item/asean-tourism-marketing-strategy-2012-2015-2> - ASEAN Tourism Marketing Strategy 2012 – 2015 (can be downloaded via link from this site)

<http://www.slideshare.net/tofujay/carrying-capacity-16284835> - Carrying capacity.

1.4 Research the compliance requirements that apply to the proposed activity/operation and location

Introduction

Planning a minimal impact tourism operation also requires research into compliance obligations which will need to be met.

This section identifies sources of possible compliance and gives examples of requirements which may need to be observed.

Sources of compliance requirements

Compliance requirements may be imposed by:

- Legislation – these are the laws (the Acts) which need to be complied with
 There may be a need to comply with the laws of individual countries in which tourism activities are being conducted and/or relevant aspects of laws which may emerge on the establishment of the ASEAN Community (AC)
- By-laws – these are mandatory rules and regulations imposed by various ‘bodies’ such as:
 - Government agencies
 - Local Councils
 - Local communities
- Voluntary Codes of Practice – which may be:
 - Generated by an industry body – in consultation with its membership as a way of setting industry-wide standards for its members
 - Imposed by a government agency – who develop them to support attainment of strategic plans they have made
 - Developed by individual Tourism Operators – as a public statement they make about themselves to customers to advertise and demonstrate their orientation and practices in regard to responsible tourism. Operators may seek to create an individual COP that provides a ‘point of difference’ for them when compared with their competitors
- Mandatory Codes of Practice – which are written by government agencies and are legally-binding requirements.
 These COPs are created under the authority of nominated pieces of legislation and are written to show organisations how they can/must operate in order to fulfil their legal obligations. In effect, if the business follows the COP, they are complying with the law
- Agreements which are already in place with local communities – as they have been negotiated with other Tourism Operators for previous tourism activities



- Arrangements already agreed to by the Tourism Operator – which may be imposed by virtue of:
 - Formal, written contracts with suppliers and/or clients
 - Verbal agreements and ‘promises made’ with partners, businesses and stakeholders.



Examples of compliance requirements

There is always a need to read documentation relevant to individual proposals to gain a proper understanding of what is necessary.

In practical terms, compliance requirements may be:

- Drivers for action – in that laws may provide tax concessions for investment in tourism initiatives
- Obstacles to development – by limiting (or prescribing) what can be done, where it can be done, when it can be done and how it can be done.

Codes identified in previous sections provide actual examples of what can be required.

The following is indicative of compliance requirements and is not intended to be comprehensive:

Legislation

Requirements which can be imposed by Acts, regulations established under those Acts and mandatory COPs may relate to:

- Employment – with possible reference to selection and hiring of staff as well as employment contracts and conditions of employment
- Building and construction – including zoning
- Incorporation and registration of organisations and operating entities
- Safety, health and welfare – as it applies to workers, customers/tourists and members of the public
- Taxation – and registration as a business and payment of applicable rates of tax which can include import taxes, company tax, bed tax, consumption tax, service tax and others
- Operational matters – such as laws governing:
 - Sale/use of alcohol
 - Food preparation, service and storage, vehicle registration
 - Vehicles – in terms of vehicle registration, licensing of drivers and obeying road rules.

Voluntary COPs

The Codes developed by industry bodies and/or individual operators are likely to contain requirements about:

- Complying with all applicable laws
- Respecting the local community, people and the environment

- Leaving an area, when on tour, in the same condition as when it was entered – referring to the need to ‘carry everything in and carry everything out’ (which may include carrying out not only all litter/rubbish but also human waste)
- Doing no harm – to people (regarding bullying, harassment, discrimination) or physical or natural resources
- Acting in an ethical and responsible manner with care, professionalism and diligence – based on sound knowledge and training
- Providing a genuine tourism experience – supported by identified or relevant information, staff, information, food, accommodation, transport and activities.



APEC/PATA Code for Sustainable Tourism

The APEC/PATA Code for Sustainable Tourism (see http://www.gdrc.org/uem/eco-tour/apec_pata-code.html) presents several statements which underpin the intent of the Code urging members to:

- “Conserve the natural environment, ecosystems and biodiversity
 - CONTRIBUTE to the conservation of any habitat of flora and fauna, affected by tourism
 - ENCOURAGE relevant authorities to identify areas worthy of conservation and to determine the level of development, if any, which would be compatible in or adjacent to those areas
 - INCLUDE enhancement and corrective actions at tourism sites to conserve wildlife and natural ecosystems
- Respect and support local traditions, cultures and communities
 - ENSURE that community attitudes, local customs and cultural values, and the role of women and children, are understood in the planning and implementation of all tourism related projects
 - PROVIDE opportunities for the wider community to take part in discussions on tourism planning issues where these affect the tourism industry and the community
 - ENCOURAGE relevant authorities to identify cultural heritage worthy of conservation and to determine the level of development if any which would be compatible in or adjacent to those areas
 - CONTRIBUTE to the identity and pride of local communities through providing quality tourism products and services sensitive to those communities
- Maintain environmental management systems
 - ENSURE that environmental assessment is an integral step in planning for a tourism project
 - ENCOURAGE regular environmental audits of practices throughout the tourism industry and to promote desirable changes to those practices
 - ESTABLISH detailed environmental policies and indicators, and/or guidelines for the various sectors of the tourism industry
 - INCORPORATE environmentally sensitive design and construction solutions in any building or landscaping for tourism purposes

- Conserve energy and reduce waste and pollutants
 - FOSTER environmentally responsible practices for:
 - reducing pollutants and greenhouse gases
 - conserving water and protecting water quality
 - managing efficiently waste and energy
 - controlling noise levels and
 - promoting the use of recyclable and biodegradable materials.
- Encourage a tourism commitment to environments and cultures
 - ENCOURAGE those involved in tourism to comply with local, regional and national planning policies and to participate in the planning process
 - FOSTER, in both management and staff of all tourism projects and activities, an awareness of environmental and cultural values
 - ENCOURAGE all those who provide services to tourism enterprises to participate through environmentally and socially responsible actions
 - SUPPORT environmental and cultural awareness through tourism marketing
- Educate and inform others about local environments and cultures
 - SUPPORT the inclusion of environmental and cultural values in tourism education, training and planning
 - ENHANCE the appreciation and understanding by tourists of natural environments and cultural sensitivities through the provision of accurate information and appropriate interpretation
 - ENCOURAGE, and support research on the environmental and cultural impacts of tourism
- Cooperate with others to sustain environments and cultures
 - COOPERATE with other individuals and organisations to advance environmental improvements and sustainable development practices, including establishing indicators and monitoring
 - COMPLY with all international conventions and national, state and local laws which safeguard natural environments and cultural sensitivities.”



1.5 Develop a plan that details the experience and activities to be implemented Research the compliance requirements that apply to the proposed activity/operation and location

Introduction

After all necessary research has been undertaken, the next step in the planning process is to develop a plan that details the experience and activities to be implemented as part of the tourism initiative.

This section presents issues to consider when preparing this plan.

Basic pre-requisites

The plan must be:

- In writing – so there is surety about it and the plan can be easily shared with others
- The result of adequate consideration and consultation – with identified stakeholders
- Realistic and achievable – within the context of the business environment for the proposer.



Standard requirements

The plan that details the experiences and activities to be implemented should address at least all of the following (and more can be added as appropriate/required):

- Explanation of how the proposal meets identified local needs – while at the same time addressing identified concerns by including action to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts
- Description of the extent and type of activities and operations proposed – including specification of the site/location to be used and the nature of the activities/operations to be conducted
- Identification of timing details – including development time, commencement dates, duration of the activity/operation and specification of daily hours of operation
- Provision of evidence proving required approvals, permissions, authorities, licenses and registrations have been approved/granted – by local communities and authorities
- Development of behaviour stipulations for tour group members – when they visit the site, participate in activities and/or engage with local people and communities
- Identification of the process that will be followed for trialling the initiative – prior to full implementation of the proposal
- Explanation of how objectors can register their objection to the proposal – together with explanation of the process that will be followed when an objection is received

- Consultation that will occur with relevant communities and individuals – prior to the final implementation decision being made
- Description of the monitoring protocols that will be used – to assess the impact of the proposal on the local environment and communities.

Sample details

The details of the trial (or ‘pilot’) to be contained in the plan and the nature of the content will vary between the types of activities being planned.

For example, the plan for the trial of an initiative to conduct an overnight tour into a new location may require specification of:



- Date/s of the trial tours
- Time/s the tour group/s will arrive
- Duration of tour/s on each date
- Number of people in each tour group
- Group profile – by relevant demographic characteristics (where appropriate for the type of activity/tour being offered – for example the Tourism Operator may be seeking to target children for school camps/excursions, or seeking to target senior citizens)
- Itinerary for each tour
- Route/s to be used – in relation to:
 - Entry to the site/area and exit from it
 - Travel within the area
 - Foot traffic and vehicles
- Location and size of camp site
- Facilities within the camp
- Interpretive activities to be conducted
- Estimated use of local resources and facilities – which might reference things such as water, wood, fuel, shops, toilet facilities, huts, cooking and dining areas and camp sites
- Details of resources to be carried into the area by the Tourism Operator – and details of items which have been declared ‘prohibited items’
- Role of local communities in the operation of the tour – such as voluntary commitment or paid work as:
 - Local area tour guides
 - Participants in certain interpretive activities
 - Labour for unpacking tour vehicles, pitching tents, setting up camps and breaking camp and packing for departure
 - Food workers employed to prepare, cook and serve meals
- Arrangements for latrines and washing facilities
- Details of waste management – which may require ‘carrying out’ of waste

- 'Code of Conduct' for tourists and tour staff when in the area
- 'Emergency Management Plans' to address events identified by standard risk management (that is, risk identification, risk assessment/evaluation and risk control) for the area, the nature of the tour and the expected/known profile/s of the tour groups
- Description of the monitoring activities to be conducted – and names of those with responsibility for undertaking them
- Description of the process to be followed to analyse and evaluate the data captured during the monitoring phase.

A very useful tool

Steps to Sustainable Tourism: planning for a sustainable future for tourism, heritage and the environment

The Australian Government, Department of the Environment and Heritage have prepared a publication called 'Steps to Sustainable Tourism: planning for a sustainable future for tourism, heritage and the environment' (available at <http://www.environment.gov.au/system/files/resources/9c8f5084-3565-4f26-8801-77da3458f497/files/steps.pdf>).

This document presents itself as 'a tool to use when managing and developing regions, places and tourism products' (p.3).

10 steps

It provides (among other things) an indication of work required before and during development of a formal written plan offering '10 steps to sustainable tourism' (pp. 7 – 55) which are listed as:

- Step 1 – What do we want to do?
- Step 2 – Who is, could be or needs to be involved?
- Step 3 – What is known?
- Step 4 – What makes this region, place or product special?
- Step 5 – What are the issues?
- Step 6 – Analysing issues
- Step 7 – Principles or objectives to guide action
- Step 8 – What are your ideas and options?
- Step 9 – How to do it?
- Step 10 – Statement of directions.



Those wishing to prepare a plan for a proposed sustainable/ minimal impact tourism initiative should obtain, read and follow the advice contained in this valuable reference.

Ways to use the document

On page 11 the document suggests:

"The 10 steps can be used in many different ways. They can help to:

- Develop audits, scoping projects and preliminary assessments of tourism development potential in regions
- Identify tourism and heritage issues which need to be considered in management, regional or business planning
- Develop regional heritage and tourism strategic plans and action plans
- Assist in developing business plans for new or existing heritage tourism products
- Foster more effective planning for infrastructure development at heritage places
- Evaluate options and establish a stronger business case for an idea or proposal.”

Those who might use the document

Information contained in the 76-page publication indicates (p. 12) the 10 steps are suitable for use by:

- Tourism operators
- Local government
- Tourism businesses and organisations
- Park managers
- Community groups
- Cultural heritage agencies and attraction managers
- Indigenous communities or enterprises
- Regional development organisations
- Interpretation officers.

Guiding principles

Four principles which have guided the development of the 10 steps are presented and discussed (pp. 13 – 14) – they are:

- Inclusive decision making
- Sustainable development
- Tourism and heritage principles
- Appropriate tourism development.

Step 9

‘How to do it?’ is particularly relevant to this section presenting itself as helping:

- Development of actions to implement ideas, proposals or preferred options
- Presentation in a clear and logical form
- Inclusion of the tourism plan with other plans
- Development of monitoring and evaluation methods



- Consideration of ‘other factors’ (strategies for gaining political support; communication; capacity building; making links; staging; influence) that will influence the attainment of objectives for the initiative.

Step 9 also provides a simple action plan format that may be used to prepare a draft plan:

What needs to be done? Proposed action or strategy)	Who should be responsible and involved?	What is the sequence and timing?	What resources are needed?	How will this action or strategy be monitored and evaluated?

Summary checklist

The document also provides a ‘Summary checklist for sustainable tourism plans’ (pp. 56 – 57) presenting the following:

- “Step 1 – What do we want to do?
Have you/have they:
 - ☐ defined the aims of this process or project?
 - ☐ understood the context for the region, place or project?
- Step 2 – Who is, could be or needs to be involved?
Have you/have they:
 - ☐ Identified the key stakeholder groups?
 - ☐ Considered when and how people should be consulted and informed?
 - ☐ Worked out how to develop effective working relationships?
- Step 3 – What is known?
Have you/have they:
 - ☐ Identified existing studies or sources of information relevant to the process or project?
 - ☐ Located and summarised data available on the current and potential market for tourism?
 - ☐ Determined the key heritage assets, their heritage values and themes?
- Step 4 – What makes this region, place or product special?
Have you/have they:
 - ☐ Identified what is special about the region, place or product?
 - ☐ Established how well its special values are recognised and currently communicated?
 - ☐ Established whether further potential exists to use these special values in tourism and interpretation?



- Step 5 – What are the issues?

Have you/have they:

- ☐ Identified and understood the key issues affecting the region, place or product?

- Step 6 – Analysing issues

Have you/have they:

- ☐ Used further analysis to clarify and prioritise issues?
- ☐ Prepared a succinct summary of the outcomes of the analysis?

- Step 7 – Principles or objectives to guide action

Have you/have they:

- ☐ Developed a clear written statement to guide future actions, such as a set of principles, set of objectives or both?
- ☐ Sought agreement on these principles or objectives from key partners or stakeholders?

- Step 8 – What are your ideas and options?

Have you/have they:

- ☐ Further refined your ideas and if necessary developed options?
- ☐ Worked through ideas and options with key stakeholders and decision makers?
- ☐ Sought agreement on preferred option/s with partners or key stakeholders?

- Step 9 – How to do it?

Have you/have they:

- ☐ Developed actions to implement ideas, proposal or preferred options?
- ☐ Presented them in a clear and logical form?
- ☐ Ensured actions are included in other plans and strategies as necessary?
- ☐ Developed monitoring and evaluation methods?
- ☐ Considered additional factors that will influence achieving objectives?

- Step 10 – Statement of directions

Have you/have they:

- ☐ prepared a brief statement summarising the outcomes of the process and proposals, identifying:
 - Key heritage and tourism assets?
 - Key issues?
 - Agreed actions and future directions?"



Six ASEAN Tourism Standards

The ASEAN National Tourism Organizations have agreed on six ASEAN Tourism Standards to help ASEAN be a Quality Single Destination.

This initiative uses a certification process to ensure tourism service providers adhere to require standards which will enable sustainable tourism and provide standardised products to visitors.

Those preparing plans for pilot sustainable/ minimal impact tourism projects should integrate the matters identified by this initiative in their planning.

Information on 'The ASEAN Tourism Standards' can be found at www.aseantourism.travel/download/doc/doc/2488, which has been used to provide the following:

"The six ASEAN Tourism Standards are:

1. Green Hotel
2. Food and Beverage Services
3. Public Restroom
4. Home Stay
5. Ecotourism
6. Tourism Heritage" (p. 2)



“Major Criteria and Requirements

1. Green Hotel

Green Hotel is a hotel which is environmentally-friendly and adopts energy conservation measures.

2. Food and Beverage Services

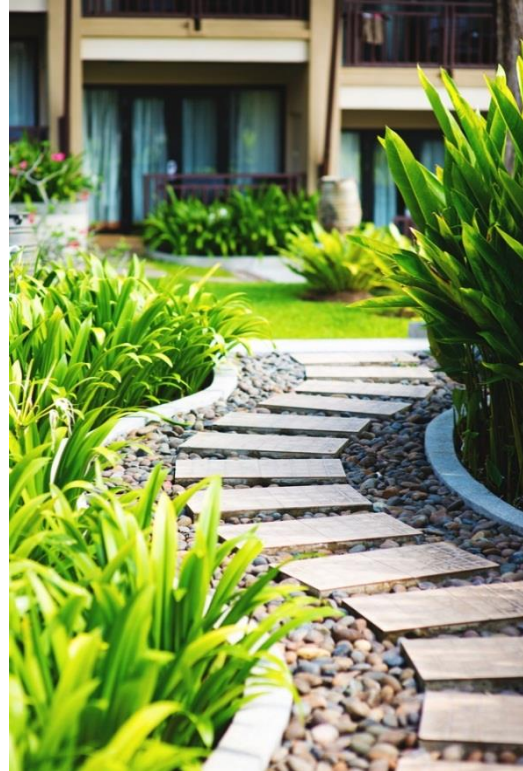
Local Food and Beverage Service is a form of service where traditional and typical food and beverages are produced and / or sold by local people in food stalls, local restaurants or other similar outlets.

3. Public Restroom

Public Restroom is a room or booth shared by all people for urination and defecation consisting of at least a bowl fitted with or without a seat and connected to a waste pipe and a flushing apparatus.

4. Home Stay

Home Stay is an alternative form of family furnished accommodation generally located in a house, providing guests opportunities to experience family/community lifestyle as well as tourist attractions.



5. Ecotourism

Ecotourism is responsible travel to destinations with ecological diversity that involves in activities, environmental and cultural conservation measures, and community participation providing benefits for the local people and the country.

6. Tourism Heritage

Tourism Heritage is an outstanding cultural or heritage area of a country that is protected, conserved and managed in a sustainable manner provided with easy access and support facilities for the enjoyment of visiting tourists.

- Cultural Heritage refers to outstanding monuments and groups of buildings in a country that have authentic, historical, archaeological, scientific, anthropological and ethnic value
- Natural Heritage refers to outstanding physical, biological and geological formations including its habitat and species that may be threatened and endangered.” (p. 5)

“ASEAN Green Hotel Standard

Major Criteria	Requirements – Hotels
1.1 Environmental policy and actions for hotel operation	1.1.1 Promotion of environmental activities in order to encourage the involvement of hotel staff, clients and suppliers to participate in environmental management practices.
	1.1.2 Existence of plan for raising staff to be aware of environment i.e. training.
	1.1.3 Existence of environmental management plan for hotel operation.
	1.1.4 Existence of monitoring program for environmental management of hotels.
1.2 Use of Green products	1.2.1 Encouragement for the use of local products for hotel operation i.e. food and handicrafts
	1.2.2 Encouragement for the use of environmentally friendly products.
1.3 Collaboration with the community and local organizations	1.3.1 Existence of plans/activities to help improve quality of life of the community.
	1.3.2 Existence of awareness raising programs for local community on environmental protection.
	1.3.3 Creation of activities in promoting culture and traditional performance and local ways of life.
1.4 Human resource development	1.4.1 Provision of training programs for operation and development management staff on environmental management.
1.5 Solid waste management	1.5.1 Introduction of waste management techniques e.g. waste reduction, reuse, recycling, waste separation and composting.
	1.5.2 Encouragement of the involvement of hotel staff in waste reduction, reuse, recycling, waste separation and composting program.
1.6 Energy efficiency	1.6.1 Introduction of energy saving techniques and / or energy-saving technology and equipment for hotel to reduce energy consumption.
	1.6.2 Installation of meters/equipment to monitor energy consumption.
1.7 Water efficiency	1.7.1 Introduction of water saving techniques and / or use of water-saving technology and equipment to reduce water consumption.
	1.7.2 Regular maintenance for water saving equipment.
1.8 Air quality management (indoor and outdoor)	1.8.1 Designation of smoking and non-smoking area.
	1.8.2 Regular monitoring and maintenance for equipment and hotel facilities to ensure the air quality i.e. air conditioning.
1.9 Noise pollution control	1.9.1 Existence of noise control program from hotel operation.
1.10 Wastewater treatment and management	1.10.1 The use of mechanisms to prevent water contamination and reduce wastewater generation.
	1.10.2 Promotion of the use of recyclable/grey water in operation i.e. watering trees.
	1.10.3 Encouragement for an appropriate use of waste water treatment.
1.11 Toxic and chemical substance disposal management	1.11.1 Provision of clear signs for toxic substance
	1.11.2 Appropriate hazardous waste disposal management.
	1.11.3 Regular inspection, cleaning and maintenance for storage in order to avoid leakage of gas or toxic chemical substance.

“ASEAN Food and Beverages Services Standard

Major Criteria	Requirements – F&B
2.1 Design and construction of food premises	2.1.1 Floors, walls and ceilings must be able to be effectively cleaned and unable to absorb grease, food particles or water.
	2.1.2 Sufficient ventilation system to effectively remove fumes, smoke, steam and vapours from the food premises.
	2.1.3 Implementation of measures to keeping the area free from animals and pests.
2.2 Facilities	2.2.1 Adequate water supply.
	2.2.2 Effective sewage and wastewater disposal system.
	2.2.3 Adequate storage to contain the volume and type of garbage and recyclable matter.
	2.2.4 Adequate toilet facilities which are maintained in a nuisance-free manner, away from food service.
2.3 Food and utensils storage	2.3.1 Clean food storage to minimize the opportunity for dirt and contamination.
	2.3.2 Storage for raw food should be separated from ready-to-eat food storage.
	2.3.3 The use of appropriate containers to store the food.
	2.3.4 Temperature of refrigerators and freezers for food that need to be stored frozen (e.g. meat, seafood, milk products, fish) should be maintained properly in order to preserve product quality.
	2.3.5 Storage should be provided off the ground for all single service articles (e.g. paper plates, cups, napkins, plastic utensils).
2.4 Food processing	2.4.1 The practicable measures should be implemented to process only safe and suitable food.
	2.4.2 Provision of adequate hand washing facilities, including soap and paper towels.
	2.4.3 The use of clean utensils (e.g. scoops, spatulas or other food dispensing devices) and/or plastic gloves to minimize direct hand contact with food.
2.5 Food disposal	2.5.1 Clear identification of food expiry.
	2.5.2 Clear separation of the food for disposal.
2.6 Health and hygiene of food handlers	2.6.1 Food handlers should be free from opened-wounds or communicable diseases.
	2.6.2 Maintain of personal hygiene of food handlers.
	2.6.3 Provision of training for staff on cleanliness and hygiene for food operation.
2.7 Cleanliness	2.7.1 Maintain food premises to a standard of cleanliness.
	2.7.2 Clean and sanitized eating and drinking utensils before use.
	2.7.3 Regular maintenance for cleaning equipment to a standard of cleanliness.
	2.7.4 Label all toxic items (e.g. detergents, bleach) and store away from food. Insecticides must be properly labelled and stored separately from detergents/ sanitizers as well as food.
2.8 Maintenance	2.8.1 Regular maintenance for fixtures, fittings and equipment to be in good condition.
	2.8.2 Eating or drinking utensils should be in good condition.
2.9 Quality Level	2.9.1 Provide the mechanism or platform for visitors to feedback on service quality.

“ASEAN Public Restroom for Tourism Standard

Major Criteria	Requirements – Public Restroom for Tourism
3.1 Design and environmental management system	3.1.1 Good waste water management system and standardized water treatment system
	3.1.2 Environmental harmonized design with the surrounding environment.
	3.1.3 Pleasant landscape
	3.1.4 Clear public restroom signboards and cleanliness keeping notice.
	3.1.5 Encourage the appropriate use of toilet.
3.2 Amenities and facilities	3.2.1 Appropriate space for each unit.
	3.2.2 Provision of adequate facilities for disabled and elderly.
	3.2.3 Provision of adequate units/cubicles for ladies and men.
	3.2.3 Provision of adequate units/cubicles for ladies and men.
3.3 Cleanliness	3.3.1 Adequate air circulation and ventilation system
	3.3.2 Good smell and no dirty slough
	3.3.3 Clean and adequate water
	3.3.4 Floor should be kept clean and dry
	3.3.5 Practice sanitation and hygiene principles
	3.3.6 Trained personnel on facility maintenance and cleanliness keeping
	3.3.7 Customers' suggestion box
	3.3.8 Regular maintenance of the toilet premises
3.4 Safety	3.4.1 Firm construction
	3.4.2 Public location
	3.4.3 Adequate lighting within and outside building
	3.4.4 Good maintenance of facilities for safety reason
	3.4.5 No slippery ground

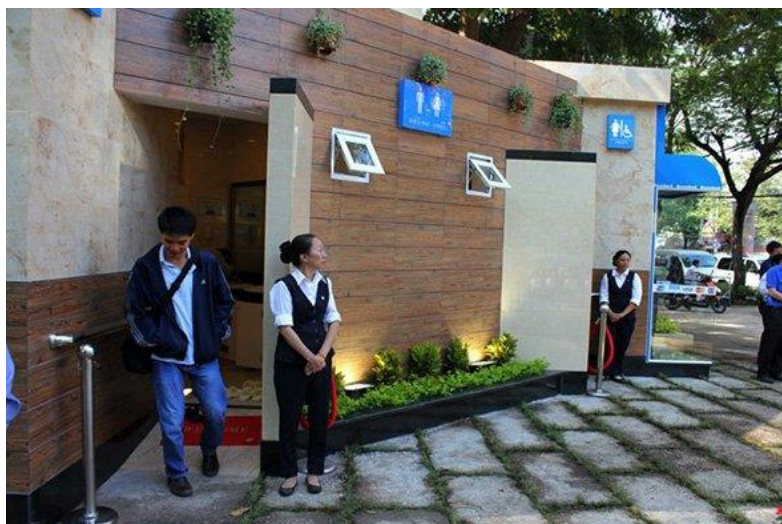


Image source: www.talkvietnam.com

“ASEAN Home Stay Standard

Major Criteria	Requirements – Home Stay
4.1 Accommodation	4.1.1 The use of local design and materials for accommodation, furniture and interior decoration.
	4.1.2 Regular monitoring and maintenance of accommodation (including the lock of doors and windows) to ensure high safety for visitors.
	4.1.3 Good ventilation system to avoid any smell.
	4.1.4 Clean bedroom and accessories.
	4.1.5 Clean washroom and toilet
	4.1.6 Regular check for insects and nuisance animals (i.e. house-rats, mosquitoes, cockroaches, ants and etc.)
4.2 Food and beverage	4.2.1 Clean and safe food and beverage.
	4.2.2 Clean and safe kitchen and kitchenware.
	4.2.3 Clean and safe fresh water.
	4.2.4 Maintain good hygiene and sanitation in food and beverage preparation and handling.
4.3 Safety and security	4.3.1 Regular monitoring for safety in the area.
	4.3.2 Provision of training on safety and security.
	4.3.3 Availability of emergency guidelines or measures.
	4.3.4 Provision of necessary/updated information to ensure the safety and security of visitors.
	4.3.5 Regular maintenance of home appliances to avoid any accident.
	4.3.6 Accessibility to public facilities i.e. hospital and clinic, public telephones, post office, police station.
4.4 Activities offered to visitors as part of home stay program	4.4.1 Provision of environmentally friendly activities that do not create any negative impacts to the area.
	4.4.2 Involvement of visitors in local activities e.g. handicrafts, arts, language, traditional dance, traditional events and festivals.
	4.4.3 Provision of necessary information about cultural activities to visitors.
4.5 Environmental conditions	4.5.1 Appropriate number of visitors, scale and type of tourism activities and visitation period at each natural/cultural attraction that does not exceed carrying capacity of the sites.
	4.5.2 Sufficient capacity for collecting solid waste.
	4.5.3 Appropriate waste disposal practices.
	4.5.4 Adequate waste collecting bins around the site.
	4.5.5 Appropriate waste water drainage treatment.
	4.5.6 Appropriate parking area to avoid air and noise pollution from vehicles to the area and community.
	4.5.7 Community involvement in solid waste management such as waste separation, waste reuse and recycling.
	4.5.8 Regular monitoring for environmental condition of the attractions.

Major Criteria	Requirements – Home Stay
4.6 Local benefits	4.6.1 Involvement of local community in Home Stay service.
	4.6.2 Provision of education and training program for local residents on various aspects of home stay management and entrepreneurship.
	4.6.3 Maintaining and enhancing local culture, natural environment and authenticity of the community and the area
	4.6.4 The use of codes of conduct/do & don't guidelines to control visitors behaviour.
	4.6.5 Availability of interpretation plan/program that helps increase understanding of visitors and local people on the significance and authenticity of the place.
	4.6.6 Provide the mechanism or platform for visitors to feedback on service standard.
4.7 Marketing and promotion	4.7.1 Availability of marketing and promotion plan/activities including: 1) Clear target visitors and their needs. 2) Availability of promotional materials e.g. brochure, interpretative and directional signage, panels about the program and community. 3) Cooperation with local government and tour operators for marketing.



“ASEAN Ecotourism Standard

Major Criteria	Requirements
5.1 Ecotourism potential	5.1.1 Nature as the focus of tourism attraction
	5.1.2 Diversity of ecological resources/natural habitats.
	5.1.3 Undisturbed environments or environments demonstrating natural process at work i.e. wetlands, wilderness areas, or coastal areas.
	5.1.4 The site is a habitat for rare and/or unique species.
	5.1.5 Authenticity of culture of local community lived or living in the natural site.
	5.1.6 Authenticity of cultural resources found in the area.
5.2 Accessibility	5.2.1 Appropriate and sufficient access to the site.
	5.2.2 Adequacy of clear directional signage to the site.
	5.2.3 Safe for visitors to travel to the site.
5.3 Tourism activities	5.3.1 Planned and controlled activities, subject to the guidelines of the relevant authorities, conducted in high natural significant area or sensitive/fragile area to minimize the negative impact on the environment.
	5.3.2 Appropriate tourism activities compatible with local heritage, values and character.
	5.3.3 Tourism activities are planned so that tourists follow specific path to minimize the negative impact on the environment.
5.4 Environmental management	5.4.1 Determination of the carrying capacity of the site.
	5.4.2 Existence of management control/measures to ensure that tourism activities do not exceed carrying capacity of the site.
	5.4.3 Availability of environmental planning and impact assessment, which includes but may not be limited to:
	1) Appropriate design and materials used for infrastructure at site which is compatible with the local environment. 2) Minimum site disturbance in constructing new facilities/product 3) Promoting energy conservation policy 4) Availability of energy conservation program 5) Promoting solid waste reuse and recycling 6) Appropriate waste disposal that does not create any negative impacts to the environment. 7) Minimize environmental impact caused by disposal of wastewater 8) Minimum noise impacts to a level equal to or lower than background noise in the local setting 9) Minimum disturbance to wildlife 10) Minimum impact on local air quality 11) Availability of clean restrooms

5.5 Site management	5.5.1	Provide monitoring program in place to assess satisfaction of local people and tourists.
	5.5.2	Availability of training programs for staff on monitoring the carrying capacity, which includes but may not be limited to the understanding of natural and cultural values of the area, measures which are to be taken to prevent environmental degradation, and to respond to an emergency.
	5.5.3	Mechanism to ensure that visitors do not stray into fragile or sensitive area of the eco system.
	5.5.4	Existence of database on tourist statistics.
	5.5.5	Availability of a tangible contribution to conservation.
	5.5.6	Provide ongoing contributions to the local community to generate people empowerment.
	5.5.7	Demonstrate respect for and sensitivity of local cultures in both its development and operation phases.
	5.5.8	Ecotourism products meet or exceed customers expectation
	5.5.9	Provide accurate and responsible information about the product that leads to realistic expectations.
5.6 Safety and security	5.6.1	Availability of officials/ local guards to take care of safety and security for visitors.
	5.6.2	Availability of trained staff to deal with disaster/emergency.
	5.6.3	Availability of communication tools/system and emergency plan
	5.6.4	Adequacy of medical facilities and emergency response.
	5.6.5	Availability of emergency plan.
	5.6.6	Provision of information about the area (e.g. prohibited area, dangerous areas and animals) for visitors before entering the site.
5.7 Interpretation and educational program	5.7.1	Provision of brief introduction on natural environment of the site as well as ecotourism activities.
	5.7.2	Creation of appropriate ecotourism trail.
	5.7.3	Existence of visitor center or information booth to provide updated and accurate information.
	5.7.4	Availability of well-trained local guides/interpreters serving visitors.
	5.7.5	Availability of diverse interpretation media e.g.: electronic, printed or verbal guides on flora and fauna found in the habitat.
	5.7.6	Introduction of codes of conduct to educate visitors on what should or should not do when visiting the site.
	5.7.7	Promoting ASEAN Traveler's Code.



“ASEAN Tourism Heritage Standard

Major Criteria	Requirements – Heritage
6.1 Uniqueness and characteristics of heritage	Natural Heritage 1) Significance of ecological systems and natural habitats. 2) Undisturbed environments or environments demonstrating natural process at work i.e. wetlands, wilderness areas, or coastal areas. 3) Existence of rare and unique species present at the site.
	Cultural Heritage 1) Significance of the existing cultural and historical resources. 2) Authenticity and integrity. 3) Degree of survival of the archaeological remains, human values, ways of life, customs, land use, events and living traditions.
6.2 Site protection and conservation	6.2.1 Existence of management control/measures to ensure that the site capacity (in terms of resources and facilities) can absorb tourism activities.
	6.2.2 Implementation of preventive measures/management mechanisms to minimize degradation of resources.
6.3 Tourism and site management	6.3.1 Appropriate tourism activities compatible with local heritage, values and character.
	6.3.2 Involvement of local communities in the development and the management of the cultural and the natural heritage site
	6.3.3 Creation of jobs that encourage the use of local knowledge, skills and traditions.
	6.3.4 The use of appropriate off-site and on-site interpretive media to educate visitors such as: ▪ Signage/panel ▪ Brochure ▪ Visual/audio presentation ▪ Guide book ▪ Special events
	6.3.5 Availability of well-trained local guides/interpreters to serve visitors.
	6.3.6 Introduction of codes of conduct to educate visitors on what should or should not do when visiting the site.
	6.3.7 Monitoring program in place to assess tourism impacts on the site.
6.4 Environmental management	6.4.1 Provision of appropriate and sufficient waste management system.
	6.4.2 Put in place waste water treatment.
	6.4.3 Zoning parking area for the site.
	6.4.4 Control and regulate the entry of objects, materials and vehicles to the site.
6.5 Accessibility	6.5.1 Sufficient infrastructure and facilities to enable easy and safe access to the site.
	6.5.2 Adequate and clear directional signage to the site.
6.6 Support facilities	6.6.1 Adequacy of facilities such as medical care, F&B outlets, electricity, water supply, restrooms, communication tools.
	6.6.2 Availability of skilled staff, officials/ local guards and other measures to take care of safety and security for visitors.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project forms the basis for following Work Projects

To fulfil the requirements of the Work Projects for this Unit you are required to identify a minimal impact tourism initiative (such as a tour) to be approved by your Trainer/Assessor and plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations in a real or simulated setting.

1.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are required to undertake necessary planning activities for the identified minimal impact tourism initiative providing evidence you have:

- Described the proposed initiative giving full details of what it will contain/entail
- Identified the place in which the initiative is to be conducted specifying the exact and total physical/geographical location involved
- Researched relevant environmental factors which may be impacted by the proposed activity
- Researched relevant socio-cultural factors which may be impacted by the proposed activity
- Researched relevant economic factors which may be impacted by the proposed activity
- Researched relevant compliance requirements applicable to the type of activity and location
- Produced a comprehensive plan (including monitoring procedures) which will enable a pilot/trial of the proposed initiative.

Summary

Plan minimal impact operations

When planning minimal impact operations:

- Seek to create a sustainable tourism outcome
- Operate in an open, honest and transparent manner
- Undertake all planning using a consultative and collaborative approach
- Ensure there is certainty about the proposal
- Identify the specific geographic location where the operation will occur
- Identify and actively include relevant stakeholders
- Determine environmental factors which may be impacted
- Identify societal and cultural factors which may be impacted
- Specify ecological factors which may be impacted
- Describe economic factors which may be impacted
- Research all factors which have been assessed as being impacted
- Become aware of all applicable mandatory and voluntary compliance requirements attaching to implementation of the initiative
- Prepare a detailed written plan to guide a pilot/trial of the proposal
- Obtain approval for the plan from stakeholders.

Element 2:

Trial minimal impact operations

2.1 Organise for the trial to be conducted

Introduction

Standard practice in relation to sustainable tourism activities/projects is to conduct, monitor and evaluate a trial of the initiative prior to its full and/or permanent implementation.

This section identifies sample details for a sustainable initiative and presents considerations and activities which need to be addressed.



Step 1: Confirming details of agreed plans

Confirming the plans/details for the trial/pilot of an activity may:

- Require presentation and explanation of final trial plans – in a face-to-face meeting with stakeholders/local communities
- Involve explanation of details
- Necessitate responses to questions and concerns
- Verify checks and monitoring activities which have been provided as an integral element of the trial
- Demand readiness to make last-minute changes which may be required by key stakeholders – or to address valid issues which have been overlooked
- Result in re-formulating draft trial plans.

Communicating with stakeholders

The need for communicating with stakeholders cannot be over-stated. It is a critical element at all stages of any tourism initiative.

At this stage of the process communication can require:

- Sharing hard copy plans with them – which may mean:
 - Distributing hard and/or soft copies prior to meetings – so attendees can read them and think about them prior to meetings
 - Providing handouts at meetings – to those who have not already received them
 - Screening PowerPoint versions of the plan at group meetings
 - Verbally explaining the plan

- Verifying approval/s – which have previously been promised, or provisionally given
- Encouraging and/or obtaining cooperation – with the trial process
- Negotiating final details – as/if required and/or negotiating ‘agreed amendments’ to the trial
- Maintaining positive relationships which have been established.

Communication may feature:

- Community meetings – on-site and./or with local communities at a place of their choosing
- Face-to-face discussions with key individuals
- Telephone contact
- Distribution of hard copy plans – supported by verbal explanations and other explanatory documentation, as required (such as copies of legislation, COPs, reports).



Establishing infrastructure to support the initiative

In this respect it is necessary to note:

- This is not required for all initiatives – as it is possible the necessary infrastructure may already exist
- Tourism Operators are reluctant to pay significant sums of money for trials – because there is no guarantee the trial will translate into an ongoing activity/operation
- Where there is support from government agencies there is a likelihood they will contribute some ‘seeding’ funding to initiate the project and demonstrate their commitment to the project

The definition of infrastructure in the context of a trial takes on a slightly different and ‘reduced’ meaning – in that it often refers to the building of smaller buildings than normal and the creation of temporary facilities rather than permanent ones.

It might involve:

- Pegging out (or grading) of tracks to be used – as opposed to the actual building of roads or boardwalks
- Trucking in portable facilities – rather than building them on-site
- Making arrangements with local people, communities and/or businesses to supply the identified needs for the initiative – as distinct to creating/establishing them from scratch, or transporting all goods into the area.

The Tourism and Transport forum Australia offer the following on page 1 of their publication ‘Tourism infrastructure policy and priorities’ (available at http://www.infrastructureaustralia.gov.au/policy-publications/submissions/published/files/259_tourismandtransportforum_SUB.pdf):

“Tourism infrastructure is the supply chain of transport, social and environmental infrastructure collaborating at a regional level to create a destination including:

- *Transport infrastructure* which provides visitor access from international and domestic source markets to destinations; and includes airports, major roads and rail

- *Social infrastructure* which is the stock of rooms to accommodate visitors and physical structures for exhibitions, events and services that attract visitors. This infrastructure includes hotels, convention centres, stadiums, galleries and tourist precincts in a destination
- *Environmental infrastructure* which is the natural estate of national parks, marine parks and reserves, including visitor facilities
- *Collaborative Infrastructure* which is the network of regional, state and national tourism organisations that market destinations and distribute tourism product”
and

“This tourism infrastructure is primarily built on private capital, with the private sector contributing 78% of total tourism investment

International airports and accommodation room stock is private infrastructure

Road, rail and seaports are typically public infrastructure

Infrastructure such as convention centres and national parks are public assets provided due to market failure or for social and environmental policy objectives.”

Indeed, the need for suitable infrastructure in ASEAN can be seen from the fact one of the ‘... general activities to enhance cooperation in ASEAN tourism ... [is the] ... Promotion of tourism incentives to facilitate the development of tourism infrastructure and other related travel and tourism facilities.’ (Source: ‘Plan of Action on ASEAN cooperation in Tourism’ at <http://www.asean.org/communities/asean-economic-community/item/plan-of-action-on-asean-cooperation-in-tourism>).

Putting identified monitoring equipment and systems in place

The monitoring resources for the trial will have been identified in the plan for the trial.

Requirements, traditionally, are:

- Presented by the proponent as the strategies to use
- Compulsorily required by government agencies
- Insisted on by local communities
- Suggested by paid/third party consultants
- Responsive to particular identified concerns for the area and/or the type of initiative being trialled – these concerns may be (for example) about the impact on local people, the effect on the environment, and/or the use of local resources
- Based on effective techniques used in other similar trials.



Examples of monitoring equipment and systems can range from basic resources to high-technology equipment – see section 2.3 for data/information gathering options.

Detailing evaluation criteria and parameters

Most trials will set criteria by which the trial will be evaluated.

Some will not.

Standard practice is to pre-determine how the trial will be assessed *before* the trial commences with reference to:

- Topics of interest or concern ('criteria') for local communities or other stakeholders – such as (for example):
 - Quality of local water or a designated water source
 - Noise levels generated by tour groups
 - Crimes reported as a consequence of the initiative
 - Money spent in local community by tour groups
 - Satisfaction of tour group members with the experience (activity/project)
- Parameters for determining whether or not the trial was 'acceptable' (and could therefore go ahead) or 'not acceptable' (and would need to be abandoned or amended and re-trialled), such as:
 - 'Up to 10% use of drinking water is acceptable'
 - 'Decrease of over 5% of XYZ flora or fauna is unacceptable'
 - '10 complaints from the local community'
 - 'Minimum 75% satisfaction rating from tour group members'.



Committing to transparency

It is essential the trial process is characterised by openness and honesty so a vital element of organising the trial is to publicly commit to transparency in relation to:

- Conducting the trial – and enabling stakeholders and relevant others to watch what occurs
- Observing the monitoring process – and how and when data is gathered
- Allowing and facilitating stakeholder participation in the monitoring process – to demonstrate inclusivity
- Releasing truthful, comprehensive and accurate findings of the trial – based on actual evidence gathered
- Facilitating stakeholder engagement with process – by providing venues and facilities for meetings to discuss the initiative and the evaluation.

The commitment to transparency should be made at the outset when first contact is made with stakeholders and other interested parties.

Establishing initial benchmarks

The establishment of initial baseline data against which comparisons will be made following the trial is a critical reference point for post-trial evaluations.

This baseline data provides details of the area (and topics of interest) at the start of the initiative before the trial commences.

No trial can/should begin until these benchmarks have been identified and agreed to.

The benchmarks chosen:

- May be decided on by one or more of the stakeholders
- Must be relevant to the individual proposal/initiative
- Should be decided on in consultation with stakeholders
- Must address identified issues and concerns
- Will form the basis of deciding the evaluation criteria and determining their parameters.



2.2 Conduct the trial operation as planned

Introduction

When all the necessary planning and organisation has been finalised the next step is to implement the trial of the proposed initiative.

This section identifies necessary aspects of this stage of the process.

Implementing the trial

When implementing the trial for a proposed sustainable tourism activity or operation there is a need to:



- Conduct the trial exactly as planned – so outcomes can be readily matched against planned actions as this is an essential pre-requisite for a viable evaluation of the trial

The publicly stated details of (say) a tour must be adhered to – in terms of things such as group numbers, vehicles used, duration, activities, arrival and departure dates

- Meet with those who have monitoring responsibilities – to confirm:
 - They have been trained
 - They are ready and able to undertake their allocated duties
 - They have the necessary resources to complete their role/s
 - They understand what is expected of them
- Record any variations that are necessary to the planned implementation – this acknowledges things rarely go exactly as planned and there is a need to adapt on-the-spot as the need to do so arises
- Take action to ensure implementation of the trial reflects future actual tourist activity *after* the trial – that is, nothing must be done to influence the behaviour, impact or presence of tourists or the group *during* the trial period

The monitoring data captured needs to be a real reflection of tourist impact/s so evaluation decisions are based on genuine information, not false or otherwise misleading information

- Seek permission from stakeholders to vary the agreed plan in advance of making any changes to previously agreed protocols – if this is possible
- Be prepared to delay implementation if there are significant unexpected or unforeseen issues arising – which common sense demands require input from, or the approval from, stakeholders
- Be available – so:
 - Stakeholders can discuss important/urgent issues
 - Monitoring information can be received and acknowledged
 - Problems arising can be decided
 - Interest in the trial can be demonstrated.

2.3 Monitor the impacts of the trial

Introduction

As the sustainable tourism initiative is implemented the planned monitoring of the initiative must also be applied.

This section discusses standard underpinning requirements in this regard and explains commonly used options for the monitoring of sustainable tourism trials.

Standard pre-requisites

Standard industry protocols when implementing monitoring activities are:

- Train the people who are to undertake monitoring activities – so they:
 - Know what to do in relation to their allocated role/topic
 - Are competent in what they need to do
 - Know how to gather sufficient, valid, reliable and objective quantitative and qualitative data
- Establish one contact point for the monitoring process – so people involved in the monitoring activity have a single, known person to:
 - Contact if they have a question, concern or problem
 - Forward their data/information to
- Verify required resources have been provided – which can include:
 - Double-checking individuals have received their log books, sighting forms and similar
 - Making sure equipment/technology to be used is in place, has been correctly calibrated and is operating as intended
- Set dates for the return of information which has been captured – to give sufficient time for the data to be analysed and evaluated so required decisions can be made and necessary reports can be written
- Provide easy-to-use channels to facilitate the return of information – such as:
 - One telephone number
 - A website or email address
 - A postal address
 - People who will travel to the data collectors to collect the data from them
- Oversee and manage the monitoring process – by, for example:
 - Being proactive in communicating with those who are monitoring the trial to determine if they have issues or need assistance
 - Ensuring identified monitoring practices are being undertaken as planned/promised
 - Following up with people when expected data is not submitted by the due time/date
 - Arranging for extra or different personnel to perform monitoring activities as the need to do so emerges



- Make public the raw data as it is obtained – to demonstrate the commitment to transparency, honesty and openness. This may be done by:
 - Posting data on a nominated website
 - Issuing press releases showing the information captured
 - Making public statements regarding the data gathered.

Data gathering options

Data gathering for the purposes of monitoring the impacts of a sustainable tourism project may involve:

- Completing hand-written (or computer/lap-top/tablet-based) documents such as:
 - Logs – these will record what happened and when it happened and will be used to record dates, times, numbers, times, statistics, observations, names of groups, points of interest or concern
 - Sighting forms – these can be targeted to record observations in relation to nominated topics which might relate to:
 - Movement or sighting of animals/wildlife
 - Identification of introduced threats, risks, dangers or hazards to the area
 - Observed actions/behaviour of tour groups
 - Observed impacts of the tourism initiative on local communities
 - Notebooks – which can be used to allow designated persons to record their generic observations, thoughts and feelings about the initiative as it unfolds
- Obtaining photographic evidence – which may require distribution of still and movie cameras to designated people to allow them to:
 - Capture proof of ‘before and after’ scenarios and the actual operation of the trial (such as the conduct of interpretive activities; the camp site used; the way tour groups interact with the community and landscape)
 - Gather visual data to support, supplement and/or explain other observations as contained (for example) in logs, notebooks, personal observations and anecdotal evidence
- Using technology and equipment to take basic measurements relating to environmental, ecological and related concerns – such as:
 - Taking temperature/s
 - Noting weather conditions
 - Calculating estimations of percentage cover of flora in an area
 - Determining fauna movement/s
 - Recording water flow
 - Measuring water volumes
 - Monitoring air quality
 - Counting customer traffic



- Gathering anecdotal evidence – through being proactive and:
 - Talking to tour group members about their experience
 - Discussing the initiative one-on-one or in a group setting with local communities and encouraging them to discuss their observations, feelings and concerns
 - Listening and noting what people (members of the public, stakeholders, those with monitoring responsibilities) say ‘by the way’ when they submit formal data or make contact for any reason in relation to the trial
- Liaising with key stakeholders – which can include:
 - Asking tour leaders/project managers to complete feedback forms/reports
 - Holding meetings to facilitate exchanges and contributions
 - Recording details of what is said and who says them.



2.4 Evaluate the information generated by the trial

Introduction

When the trial has been completed and relevant information/data has been collected it must then be analysed and evaluated to determine the impacts of the trial.

This section highlights basic necessities when evaluating data and looks at a range of impacts which have been identified in the past as flowing from tourism initiatives.

Important points to note

When evaluating the information generated by the trial it is important to:

- Base decisions on facts and evidence – all findings must be able to be supported by proof, and defended or be able to be validated if challenged
- Reference evaluations to the criteria and parameters established for the trial – as these are the keys for determining the final outcome/s for the trial
- Consider quantitative data and qualitative information – as both of these have a role ('two sides of the same coin') in the total evaluation of any trial, providing factual evidence as well as descriptive references
- Align relevant data to identified topics – so there is a direct link between criteria established for the trial and the data which was captured
- Analyse positive and negative impacts – in theory, every tourism trial holds the potential to generate positive and negative outcomes so the evaluation needs to be alert to identifying, describing and quantifying both potential results in order to achieve balanced and unbiased findings
- Highlight any difficulties, problems or issues which occurred during the trial period – and which may have (or actually *did*) impact on the trial and data which was collected
- Involve the stakeholders in the process to demonstrate transparency – and to avoid conducting the evaluation behind closed doors and generating results and recommendations ('findings' of the trial) in private
- Generate additional data if required – this may occur when:
 - Where insufficient data exists on which to base decisions
 - When the data is deemed not to be reliable or valid
 - An issue has arisen necessitating more or different data to be gathered
 - An error in data collection has been identified
 - Significant disagreement exists among stakeholders about the legitimacy of the data being relied on



- Explain the methodology used to undertake the evaluation – so those reading the findings can understand:
 - How the data was collected and analysed
 - How the decisions made as a result of the trial were arrived at
- Generate a set of clear and distinct findings as a result of the evaluation – which will be presented as the basis for moving the sustainable tourism project forward
- Communicate the outcomes of the trial – by sharing, publishing or otherwise widely communicating the findings.



Environmental impacts

The possible positive impacts may include:

- Opportunities for conservation and protection of buildings and facilities – as a consequence of Tourism Operators wanting to preserve these things and/or enhance them for the benefit of tourists
- Opportunities for conservation and protection of the natural environment – where the Tourism Operator is prepared to take action to protect the landscape against threats in order to preserve it for tour groups to experience and enjoy
- Education of visitors relating to local environmental issues – meaning the message about local problems and challenges can be spread around the world and awareness of the problem/s might stimulate action to mitigate problems
- Potential to improve sites that have been de-graded prior to the initiative – in that Tourism Operators are often prepared to pay for the repair and/or upkeep of buildings and the natural environment.

Possible negatives outcomes can include:

- Physical damage to building and facilities – caused by pedestrian traffic, vehicles, use/extra use (normal 'wear and tear') as well as accidental and deliberate damage
- Damage to the natural environment – including soil/land erosion, compacting of soil, use of land for buildings, car parks, camp sites
- Pollution – which may involve air (smoke) pollution, water pollution, noise pollution
- Presence of waste – or additional litter/rubbish and human waste
- Use of local limited energy resources (water and wood)
- Adverse visual impacts on the site/area – as the initiative negatively affects the beauty of the area or interrupts or interferes with the 'look and feel' of the location.

Social impacts

The possible positive impacts may include:

- Improved facilities and infrastructure – which can be used by local communities and/or which provide enhanced experiences (such as comfort and safety) for tourists
- Improved understanding regarding local issues – so there is wider awareness, and appreciation of these problems which can lead to a better understanding of the communities and *may* trigger external assistance for problems
- Improved relationships between the local community and other communities – based on the knowledge which flows when there is interaction between the two
- More things for local communities to do – and increased opportunities for them to interact with others and expands their horizons to become more aware of other cultures, countries and communities.



Possible negatives social outcomes can include:

- Social dislocation – which disrupts the established pattern of communities and may cause changes to ‘regular’ things such as where people live, how they work and changes to traditional lifestyles and values
- Potential for increase in criminal activities – caused commonly by tourists stealing from local communities, or by local communities stealing from tourists

The potential for assaults, prostitution and child sex may also be an issue

- Reduced focus on (and potential interruptions to) traditional social interactions and activities between people in the local communities – caused by:
 - The physical presence of tourists
 - Competing pressures on time
 - Stress caused by the need to accommodate tourist-related needs/demands.

Ecological impacts

The possible positive impacts may include:

- Increased awareness of ecological issues – these will vary between locations but it is generally accepted raising awareness of ecological problems that exist in an area is a good thing in that it:
 - Can encourage action to stop or reduce activity that is causing the problem
 - Attract external assistance to mitigate the rate of degradation which is occurring
- Potential for investment in the area – to:
 - Create additional habitat to encourage the growth and development in numbers and species of flora and fauna
 - Rehabilitate damaged land
 - Protect existing areas from damage

Possible negatives ecological outcomes can include:

- Damage to flora – which may be:
 - Trampled by foot and vehicle traffic
 - Illegally picked/removed
 - Overcome by introduced plant-life
- Disturbance to fauna – which may entail them:
 - Being scared away from the area by the tourist activity
 - Being hunted by tourists
 - Being preyed on by feral/exotic species.



Economic impacts

The possible positive impacts may include:

- Increased employment opportunities for local population – giving:
 - Higher levels of disposable income
 - Improved standards of living from a material perspective
- Increased investment in the local area – which:
 - Generates all the benefits of the multiplier effect
 - Tends to be self-perpetuating in that one lot of investment often attracts more investment from other parties
- Increased local revenue – which has flow-on effects on:
 - Foreign exchange earnings
 - Taxation
 - Local spending potential on local facilities.

Possible negatives economic outcomes can include:

- Potential for unacceptable levels of inflation – as prices of local commodities (food, housing, land, resources) increase as a result of the standard economic ‘supply and demand’ principle
- Diversion of a country’s limited funds from other necessary projects towards tourism activities – thereby causing increased hardship on locals
- Problems resulting from ‘too much’ reliance on tourism income when there is an unexpected and dramatic downturn in tourist numbers/spending.

Cultural impacts

The possible positive impacts may include:

- Sharing of culture with the wider community – which can bring greater recognition to communities regarding their rites, celebrations and their unique nature which serves to generate greater interest in the area and attract more tourists
- Better understanding of culture amongst other communities.

Possible negatives cultural outcomes can include:

- Trivialisation of the culture – and exploitation of it for commercial gain and to satisfy the interests of outsiders
- Offence (often unintended) given to locals by the comments, dress and behaviour of visitors
- Potential for established culture to be altered against the will of and despite the activities of the local community – such as the so-called ‘Westernisation’ of communities and a diminution on the importance of family.



Websites

Take the time to visit:

http://www.sustainabletourisonline.com/awms/Upload/Resource/bookshop/90038%20Scott_IPATpilotStudy%20WEB.pdf – Industry Performance Analyser for Tourism: Research and Pilot Study

http://crctourism.com.au/wms/upload/resources/bookshop/Ham_ToolEvalInterp.pdf - Development of a Research-Based Tool for Evaluating Interpretation

<http://www.nzcycletrail.com/sites/default/files/uploads/NZCT%20Final%20Report%20-%20Angus%20and%20Angus.pdf> – Final Report: New Zealand Cycle Trail Evaluation – Train Case Studies.

<http://unesdoc.unesco.org/images/0018/001826/182646e.pdf> - The effects of tourism on culture and the environment in Asia and the Pacific

<http://www.slideshare.net/ejaysamson/sociocultural-impacts-of-tourism> - Socio-cultural impacts of tourism.

2.5 Utilise the information from the trial to modify previous plans so as to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts

Introduction

The culmination of the trial for the sustainable tourism initiative is the use of the information from the pilot to determine the future of the activity/operation.

This section presents and discusses the considerations and possible actions which may follow the conclusion of a trial/pilot.

Important notes

Following the evaluation of a trial it is important to understand:

- The findings of the evaluation must be used to guide future action – these finding cannot be ignored and must not be manipulated to make them fit/accommodate pre-determined ends or objectives
- Involvement of stakeholders must continue – their inclusion in the project needs to be of an ongoing and remain characterised by transparency and honesty
- There can be a need to run a supplementary trial – where the evidence and/or evaluation proved to be:
 - Lacking the detail required in relation to the identified criteria and parameters
 - Insufficient to allow decisions to be made
 - Significantly controversial
 - Obviously flawed.



Considerations and options

It is possible, based on the finding of the evaluation of the trial there can be a need to:

- Cancel the proposed activity/operation – Tourism Operators must be prepared to do this if the data from the trial indicates the initiative:
 - Will have significant/unacceptable impacts on the area and/or local community
 - Does not have necessary support
- Revise aspects of the plan that were highlighted as negative as a consequence of the trial – this can necessitate:
 - Altering the types and nature of tour activities
 - Shifting the physical location of routes, sites used and/or interpretive activities
 - Varying the size or scope of the proposal
 - Changing timing considerations
 - Increasing the amount of investment

- Using different personnel
- Constrain the impact of the plans – by:
 - Reducing the area/s visited or involved in the initiative
 - Lowering numbers in tour groups
 - Visiting the area on a less frequent basis
 - Conducting fewer interpretive activities
 - Restricting vehicle access
- Expand plans for those aspects of the plan that received a positive trial result – which may mean:
 - Increasing the duration of tours
 - Extending the initiative into other areas
 - Raising tour group numbers
 - Including extra interpretive activities
 - Creating additional sustainable initiatives to be trialled in the same location
- Gain necessary approvals and authorisations from key stakeholders for any revised plans which are to be developed – following the same consultative process which has been used to-date.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from Work Project 1.1

2.1 For the minimal impact tourism initiative identified in Work Project 1.1 trial the proposal (in a real or simulated setting) providing evidence you have:

- Organised for the trial to be conducted
 - Conducted the trial operation as planned
 - Monitored the impacts of the trial
 - Evaluated the information generated by the trial
 - Utilised the information from the trial to modify previous plans so as to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts.
-

Summary

Trial minimal impact operations

When trialling minimal impact operations:

- Verify plan for the pilot has been approved
- Implement the trial strictly in accordance with the plan
- Provide necessary information, training, resources and infrastructure to enable the trial
- Provide necessary monitoring training and resources
- Communicate the plan for the trial to those who have responsibilities for action under the plan
- Involve stakeholders
- Establish initial benchmarks
- Gather monitoring data/information to address identified evaluation criteria and parameters
- Follow-up as required to ensure sufficient, reliable and valid data is captured
- Evaluate evidence obtained as a result of the approved monitoring activities
- Modify trial plans on the basis of data gathered and decisions made following analysis the data
- Seek to optimise positive impacts and reduce/eliminate negative impacts.

Element 3:

Implement minimal impact operations

3.1 Apply revised plans to the practical application of minimal impact tourism activities/operations

Introduction

When the draft plan for the tourism initiative has been trialled, evaluated, revised and approved, the revised plan can next be implemented.

This section presents standard generic requirements to be observed in relation to this stage of the process.

Essential requirements

When applying the revised plans for the sustainable tourism initiative it is vital to:

- Confirm the plan has been revised and approved for implementation by relevant stakeholders – this can mean:
 - Sighting an appropriately signed document
 - Attending a stakeholder meeting and obtaining permission/vote to proceed with the revised plan
- Share the revised plans – which can require:
 - Involving the media by advising them of progress
 - Inviting media to participate in a reviewed activity
 - Going into local communities to talk to them and distribute copies of new plans
 - Communicating revised plans to general public – by (for example) posting on organisational website, and advertising in the media
- Implement the plans as revised – which means:
 - Adhering strictly to the requirements of the revised plan
 - Not straying off track and ‘inadvertently’ returning to actions and activities in the draft/pilot plan
 - Resourcing activities as necessary to ensure the plan for the initiative can be applied as intended
 - Using nominated personnel, communities, locations, activities, access routes, dates and times



- Use minimal impact techniques – these will depend on the individual initiative but can involve or provide opportunity for:
 - Providing suitable education on appropriate behaviour for tour leaders/staff and tour group members
 - Undertaking necessary site hardening to enable sites to cater for the known or expected visitor numbers – this may involve construction of buildings, putting hard surfaces on tracks to protect against erosion, or surfacing of roads
 - Applying technological solutions to identified problems – as appropriate to each type of challenge/difficulty identified: which may involve for example:
 - Use of solar energy to provide power
 - Use of ICT and mobile technologies to disseminate/provide visitor information – instead of paper-based materials/handouts
 - Restricting or limiting access to sites and areas
 - Staged authenticity – where events and activities are re-created in a managed/controlled way and presented as an ‘authentic’ representation of the real/actual event/s thus:
 - Protecting the privacy of local communities
 - Enabling issues relating to unwanted intrusion to be dealt with
 - Allowing more people/‘everyone’ to see or experience the event/s
- Align with the six ASEAN Tourism Standards – as described in section 1.5 in relation to:
 - Green Hotel
 - Food and Beverage Services
 - Public Restroom
 - Home Stay
 - Ecotourism
 - Tourism Heritage
- Liaise with key stakeholders by communicating frequently with them via meetings and other identified/preferred methods of contact – to:
 - Ensure ongoing support and positive relationships
 - Solicit stakeholders feedback and input
 - Share problems and issues
 - Obtain help from stakeholders to resolve problems
 - Communicate progress reports
 - Respond appropriately to problems and comments.



3.2 Conduct the activity/operation in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions

Introduction

A responsible orientation to the implementation of sustainable tourism initiatives requires the project is undertaken in such a way it encourages others to also engage in minimal impact actions in their tourism-related endeavours.

This section looks at the need to do this and presents strategies which can encourage other Tourism Operators to adopt a 'sustainable' orientation to their tourism practices.



Rationale

There is a need to conduct sustainable tourism initiatives in a way that encourages others to do the same in order to:

- Demonstrate the professionalism of the organisation – to the wider community
- Show genuine commitment to 'sustainability' – by doing 'a little bit extra' than the minimum that is required
- Demonstrate transparency – in the entire implementation process by proving the organisation is prepared to let other see what they are doing
- Prove organisational interest in 'sustainability' is ongoing – and not just focussed on *this* initiative
- Attract public attention to the areas/issues of concern – and highlight how these are being effectively addressed
- Promote the 'Six ASEAN Tourism Standards' – and related policies
- Provide a truthful basis for making positive public statements about the organisation and its 'sustainable' credentials – in advertisements and on the website.

Strategies to encourage engagement

It is possible to encourage engagement of other Tourism Operators in sustainable tourism initiatives by applying a mix of the following:

- Acting as a role model for action – by, for example:
 - Taking responsible decisions
 - Putting the planet before profit
 - Involving stakeholders and local communities
 - Listening to stakeholders and local communities
 - Responding to stakeholders and local communities by altering plans – and, where necessary, abandoning project/s

- Sharing lessons learned with industry, government agencies and other Tourism Operators – which may involve:
 - Posting information on a public website
 - Distributing reports, evaluations and findings
 - Actively helping others who wish to commence a sustainable tourism project
- Becoming an advocate for sustainability – and, perhaps:
 - Speaking on behalf of ‘sustainability’ at public meetings and industry events
 - Talking about the benefits which have flowed from having taken a ‘sustainable’ approach to tourism projects
- Using the media to spread the word about sustainable tourism – in the form of:
 - Writing articles for local newspapers or magazines on sustainable tourism and how it may be achieved
 - Writing articles on the benefits to operators of engaging with sustainable tourism
 - Doing radio and television interviews on a range of ‘sustainable tourism’ topics
 - Involving the media in the initiative and inviting them to participate ‘free of charge’ in exchange for some media exposure
 - Developing press releases on a different ‘sustainability’ topics and the progress of the initiative/s.



3.3 Implement ongoing monitoring protocols

Introduction

Throughout the implementation phase of a sustainable tourism initiative there is a non-negotiable requirement to ensure the agreed monitoring protocols are applied.

This section recaps the requirements which may apply to satisfy this need.

Keys to the process

When implementing agreed monitoring protocols the points listed below need to be adhered to:

- Check necessary training has been delivered – to all those with allocated responsibilities for monitoring activities and data gathering
- Verify all required resources have been supplied as promised – to enable the identified monitoring activities to occur and be recorded as planned
- Ensure the technologies used and confirmed in the pilot are used – or varied as required on the basis of the evaluation. This may require:
 - Using different technology/systems to gather data
 - Gathering data at different/more frequent times
 - Obtaining different data
- Take action to make sure the agreed ‘other’ monitoring activities are being undertaken as planned – by the people who have been designated and with the required frequency. This relates to the activities such as personal observations, entries in log books/note books, taking of still and moving images, surveying of land used and similar
- Follow-up with those who have responsibility for monitoring activities – as required. This may be a common requirement because many of the data collectors are often unpaid volunteers

Follow-up may be required:

- If no monitoring information/data is being received
- Where there are requests for help
- If problems arise
- Where there is a very significant variation in the data received from what is normally obtained, or from what is expected
- Be actively and personally involved to show those involved (and others) there is real organisational engagement with the project, genuine desire to monitor the impacts and hands-on management of the project – this may be achieved by:
 - Helping personnel with their data gathering/monitoring activities
 - Showing people how to optimise their information gathering
 - Providing a visible on-site presence
 - Actually doing some data gathering.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from the previous Work Project.

3.1 For the minimal impact tourism initiative identified in Work Project 1.1 implement the proposal (in a real or simulated setting) providing evidence you have:

- Applied revised plans to the practical application of the minimal impact tourism initiative
 - Conducted the initiative in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions
 - Implemented ongoing monitoring protocols.
-

Summary

Implement minimal impact operations

When implementing minimal impact operations:

- Apply the approved and revised plans to the implementation of the initiative – follow the plan
- Confirm extra/different resources and training have been provided to enable implementation of revised plan
- Align with the six ASEAN Tourism Standards, if/as applicable
- Be a role model for other Tourist Operators who may also want to conduct minimal impact tourism operations
- Share lessons learned with relevant others
- Advocate for sustainable tourism
- Gather required monitoring data as an integral part of the implementation process
- Actively seek and then record feedback on the initiative.

Element 4:

Evaluate minimal impact operations

4.1 Collect objective environmental data

Introduction

As part of the overall implementation process for a sustainable tourism initiative there is a need to collect the data, as planned and agreed, throughout and at the end of the project.

This section highlights the need for planned data gathering procedures to be implemented 'as agreed/approved', looks at the difference between objective and subjective data, and discusses considerations and activities relevant to this critical part of the process.



Core requirement

The necessity of implementing the planned data gathering procedures exactly as planned and agreed to by stakeholders cannot be stressed too highly.

Whatever was presented as being planned data gathering procedures **must be undertaken**.

As soon as a proponent starts to deviate from the planned data gathering procedures:

- The opponents of the initiative may seize on this as 'evidence' of the organisation having something to hide
- The validity of the entire project starts to be questioned – if *this* needs changing, what else might also be wrong/need changing or is going to be changed?
- The credibility of the organisation suffers as people start thinking 'they only said they were going to do it in order to get approval to proceed: not why have gained their approval they are not going to do what they promised'.

What if there is a valid need to alter planned procedures?

If it ever emerges there is a legitimate need to vary the planned data gathering procedures the procedure for achieving this should involve:

- Prompt communication with stakeholders
- Detailed description of the need for the change
- Provision of supporting data/evidence of the need for change
- Presentation of changes intended explaining why and how they will achieve the objective/s described in the 'need for change'

- Request for approval for the identified changes to be implemented
- Allocation of responsibilities for new data gathering procedures
- Provision of necessary training and resources
- Integration of new strategies into established other monitoring activities.

‘Objective’ and ‘subjective’ data

There is always a need to collect qualitative and quantitative data as a part of the monitoring for any sustainable tourism initiatives.

The collection of quantitative data includes the gathering of objective environmental data.

‘Objective’ data is data is fact-based data free of personal bias, influence, opinion or thought.

By contrast, ‘subjective’ data is personal opinion, thoughts, perceptions and feelings.

Objective data is information gained as a result of some form of testing. It refers to data which is measurable and observable.

The objective data may be captured as a result of:

- Personal observation – of visible and measurable actions such as (for example):
 - Number of people who visit a site or use a facility
 - Length of time people spend at a location
 - Number of vehicles that use a road or enter an area
- Reading the meters or print-outs of technical equipment/technology which has been bought or rented for the purpose of the project – such as:
 - Hand-held water quality meters
 - Air monitors
 - Dust monitors
 - Soil samplers
 - Sound level meters
 - Vibration monitors
 - Thermometers
 - Water depth and flow gauges
 - Traffic (road count) meters
 - Turnstiles
- Conducting tests – which may seek to track statistical evidence of what happens when (for example):
 - There is a change in routes taken by tour groups
 - Interpretive activities provided to a group are altered
 - The arrival and departure times of a tour/group are varied



- Undertaking a physical examination of land or an area or other nominated site or object – such as:
 - Counting the number of a species in a designated area
 - Monitoring re-generation activities
 - Measuring waste.



Considerations and activities

When collecting objective environmental data it may be necessary to:

- Try to involve stakeholders/local communities – in order to:
 - Give them a sense of ownership in the initiative
 - Demonstrate inclusivity and collaboration
 - Prove openness and transparency of the project
- Supplement use of local communities and stakeholders with the use of a recognised professional, external consultant – who has experience with tourism initiatives and environmental monitoring, so they:
 - Can provide important third party reports for the project
 - Assist volunteers in their monitoring activities
 - Identify the need for 'other' monitoring activities to be introduced to the operation as the initiative unfolds
 - Advise of concerning issues at the earliest possible time
- Verify the testing and monitoring equipment has been correctly calibrated – which may require:
 - Getting all hand-held monitors used by volunteers or project staff are tested/calibrated and certified prior to use so their readings can be deemed 'reliable and accurate'
 - Obtaining written proof (such as a Certificate of Confirmation) from third party consultants that their equipment has been appropriately verified and certified for use as intended
- Follow-up as required with relevant people – that is, communicating with those who have been allocated data collection responsibilities if:
 - Have a query or a problem and need assistance
 - Their data is not received as and when expected
 - Data provided by them is incorrect or insufficient for the intended purpose, as explained to them during their training
- Physically collect the data – which may require:
 - Travelling to sites to read meters and equipment
 - Obtaining hard copy sheets of data from on-site collectors
 - Using telemetry connected to metering devices to obtain readings remotely
 - Liaising with consultants to capture their information
 - Retrieving data sent electronically (or otherwise) to a designated site/location – such as by email, posting to a site, text, any digital platform or mail

- Collate the data – by:
 - Assessing it to determine exactly what the data is about/what it represents or refers to
 - Entering the information provided into prescribed 'fields' in a paper-based or electronic database according to prescribed criteria identified as relevant in the planning stage
- Manipulate the data – which traditionally involves:
 - Performing a range of arithmetical functions (addition, subtraction, multiplication, division) to generate relevant totals, percentages, and ratios
 - Identifying trends which emerge from the data
 - Drawing distinctions and comparisons between 'before' and 'after' data with reference to original benchmarks which were established at the start of the initiative
 - Generating findings from the data based on statistical/fact-based evidence which can be used to support, justify, defend or otherwise explain decisions taken based on the findings
- Share the data and the findings – through a blend of approaches appropriate to the project, which may include:
 - Stakeholder meetings and public meetings
 - Press releases and interviews with the media
 - Electronic and/or paper based distribution of information
 - Posting information on a nominated website
 - Encouraging comment and feedback.



4.2 Solicit feedback from the local community and staff

Introduction

The implementation and evaluation stages of any minimal impact tourism initiative should always be characterised by feedback to the proponent organisation from its employees and the local community involved in/impacted by the project.

This section revisits the vital connection represented by feedback from stakeholders,

Types of feedback

Feedback may be:

- Provided verbally or in written form – the organisation must be prepared to record oral feedback and capture it in written or electronic form
- Positive or negative – the organisation cannot choose to only believe the positive/good feedback it receives because many valid and important points are raised as a result of negative feedback
- Offered willingly without having to be requested or sought out – or it may need to be asked for
- Given by a person or a group – some individuals prefer the anonymity of contributing feedback by being part of a larger cohort of people
- ‘Compulsory’ – while communities may make input based on their inherent involvement in the initiative and the way it is likely to impact them, others (staff, consultants, paid members of the local community) may be ‘required’ to submit feedback as part of the arrangement that is made with them.



Encouraging feedback

When soliciting feedback it is important to:

- Make people aware from the outset that feedback is being sought – and that the organisation:
 - Welcomes it
 - Provides mechanisms for people to provide it
 - Values it
 - Will take notice of it
- Maintain a feedback database/file – so all feedback provided and/or captured is recorded and can be classified and used:
 - To guide ongoing actions to achieve a minimal impact result
 - As part of the evaluation process

- Proactively seek feedback – the organisation must not only signal their initial desire for feedback but they must also, for example:
 - Ask for it at all meetings
 - Supply forms for people to complete to record their contributions
 - Apply questionnaires and surveys
 - Hold focus groups with tour group members, local communities and other involved parties
 - Conduct consultation and feedback meetings
- Thank people for making contributions – because this:
 - Is polite and respectful
 - Generates moiré feedback
 - Demonstrates the positive orientation of the organisation to feedback *even if it is negative comment*
- De-brief with staff who have been involved with the activity – which can occur:
 - Face-to-face at the conclusion of tours or activities
 - At staff meetings and briefings
 - Through the completion of mandatory Reports to be compiled at the end of each tour or activity
- Meet on-site with other parties which may be done by integrating them into a standard tour group or holding a dedicated tour/activity just for them – to:
 - Enable them to experience the initiative first-hand – as opposed to them thinking they know what the activity/operation is all about
 - Seek and record their impressions as they experience the initiative, and at the conclusion of the activity
- Sharing the feedback – with key stakeholders:
 - Verbally
 - Electronically
 - Using hard copy information.



4.3 Collaborate with local authorities to manage local environmental and social issues caused by, or related to, the minimal impact activity/operation

Introduction

A standard aim of all minimal impact tourism operations is, by definition, to minimise the impact of the initiative.

This section gives advice on how this pivotal objective can be successfully achieved.

Context

In relation to working with local authorities to manage relevant issues raised by a minimal impact tourism initiative it is important to understand:

- The Tourism Operator has a commercial objective – that is, they want to make money and obtain a satisfactory ROI from the project
This is just a simple fact of business life but it often runs contrary to the aims of other stakeholders
- Impacts can be positive or negative – not all outcomes will be advantages to a community but nor will they necessarily all be bad: refer back to section 1.3 and 2.4 for more details on this
- Different people have different perspectives and priorities – what is important for one person/group is not necessarily what is important for another person/group
The key is often to find a consensus outcome (which often needs to be negotiated – that is, there needs to be ‘give and take’ between the parties) which satisfies all those who are interested or impacted
- Issues and impacts vary over time and between different projects – based on factors which are relevant to the project and/or that apply ‘at the time’
In practice, no two minimal impact tourism initiatives are the same even though they may appear similar and even though *some* lessons learned from one operation can be successfully transferred/applied to another project
- An organisation that is genuine in its orientation to minimal impact tourism operations must be prepared to walk away from an initiative when it is obvious the impacts of the proposal are just too severe – this is the only sensible and responsible thing that can be done

Abandoning/cancelling a project for this reason may be costly to the organisation but it has benefits in terms of its industry reputation and the credibility such a decision will create with customers, government agencies and local communities generally

Such a decision also tends to make future minimal impact tourism initiatives much easier to plan, trial and implement



The four basic options in the process

Essentially the options at this stage are to:

- Abandon the project – which may require:
 - Removing structures and/or infrastructure built in the location on a permanent or temporary basis for the initiative (or these may remain as a donation/gift by the Tourism Operator to the local community, if agreeable to both parties)
 - Re-generating damaged or impacted land
 - Replenishing depleted resources
 - Paying compensation to the local community
- Do nothing – which means, for example:
 - Continue running tours as previously done
 - Employ the same people
 - Visit/conduct activities in the same location with the same frequency
 - Maintain visitor/tour/activity numbers
- Capitalise on any positive outcomes – which may involve, for example:
 - Building extra buildings or roads
 - Employing more people
 - Conducting more tours or activities
 - Expanding the area used by the pilot program and subsequent activities
 - Increasing the duration of tours/activities
 - Transferring the initiative to another site/community
- Reduce/eliminate all negative outcomes – which may require action such as:
 - Re-locating elements of a tour/activity to a slightly or significantly differently geographic site – to preserve sites which are getting damaged
 - Lowering the amount of interaction between tour groups/visitors and nominated aspects of the site/local community – so there is less social impact
 - Reducing the frequency of tours/activities and/or the number of tourists in each group – in order to lower the likelihood of negative outcomes
 - Restricting the tour/activity site – by limiting activities and routes to more confined areas which will again protect delicate areas and reduce the potential for negative social impacts
 - Altering the inclusions for the tour – so environmental concerns are addressed by removing interaction with (for example) a threatened geographical feature or a natural feature which has shown adverse readings in the monitoring process
 - Changing the required Code of Behaviour for tourists who engage with the local community as part of the tour/activity – so the revised requirements address issues which are causing damage or offence to the social structure of the community
 - Negotiating a trade-off with the local community – whereby they may be paid for things which have had a harmful impact on them, or be given (for example) assistance in terms of medical help, food, clothing, buildings, fuel or other goods and services deemed by them to be necessary and appropriate.



Activities in the collaboration process

When participating in the collaboration process to manage the impacts of a tourism initiative on local issues, it is necessary to:



- Attend all meetings convened by the local authorities – to demonstrate engagement and willingness with this stage of the process
- Provide requested all information/data to the local authorities – as, how and when requested
- Fund the management process – which may entail:
 - Pay for required changes to be paid
 - Pay nominated persons to attend/participate in the management process
 - Supply food and beverages and other support resources for the conduct of meetings and related other actions
- Adhere to and honour any previous promises made about what the organisation would do if the monitoring process revealed a certain outcome – the Tourist Operator must remain ‘true to their word’
- Listen to what those who disagree have to say – because it may be the case they have a valid point which needs to be addressed
- Be open and transparent when discussing issues – this can mean:
 - Showing actual evidence gathered
 - Making all information/data available – which may mean releasing information which may be regarded as damaging to the Tourist Operator
- Be hard but be fair – the management process is not one where the Tourist Operator just accepts what everyone else says and does what everyone else wants, but is one where:
 - They are entitled to have their say and argue their point
 - They should present evidence to support their case/their side of the argument
 - They are free to contest ill-informed or incorrect points which are raised by opponents of the initiative
- Conduct additional research and/or monitoring – as/if required to obtain more or different data to enable an informed decision to be made about a topic which is proving to be challenging or difficult to reconcile
- Record the discussions and findings – for future reference so there is a true and accurate record of:
 - When meetings were conducted, where they occurred and who attended
 - What was said and discussed
 - Who said what
 - Votes that were taken and the results of the votes

- Share the deliberations, discussions and decisions – so:
 - All stakeholders are aware of the process and know what took place
 - Transparency of decision making can be maintained
- Make suggestions for action – this must be done to accommodate the identified issues and concerns raised by the initiative but also needs to be done in a way that:
 - Meets the commercial imperatives of the Tourist Operator
 - Demonstrates the professionalism and industry knowledge and expertise of the Operator
 - Optimises the potential for future minimal impact tourism to be well received.



4.4 Modify previous plans on the basis of valid data obtained

Introduction

The final outcome of the evaluation of a minimal impact tourism initiative is the development of modified plans to reflect the findings generated by the data gained as a result of the monitoring process.

This section repeats some previous notes and provides a range of possible modifications which are traditionally made to these plans.

Context

The changes which are made to the plans:

- Must address identified need
- Must be put in writing
- Must be integrated into the existing plan
- Must be based on actual/factual evidence
- Must be approved by those in the project management team
- Must be communicated with relevant stakeholders and with those who have responsibility allocated to them under the revised plan.



Changes to the plans

Changes may include:

- Changing the type/nature of the operation, project, activity or initiative – which may mean:
 - Giving the initiative a different focus
 - Targeting a different market
 - Promoting in a different way
- Changing the interpretive activities included – so activities which are causing problems are replaced by ones:
 - Likely to cause less of an impact
 - More acceptable to local communities
- Changing the physical/geographic location of the initiative – such that an acceptable tour/activity is re-located to an area which causes less unacceptable impact/s
- Changing inclusions – so that inclusions causing problems are removed and (perhaps) replaced by a more acceptable alternative, for example:
 - Replacing a 5-day camp with an overnight stay
 - Replacing the distribution of pre-prepared F&B to tour group members with freshly-cooked food prepared by locals (for which they are paid)
 - Adding a local artifact as a ‘free gift’ from the Tourist Operator as part of the package (which is purchased from local artisans)

- Using different tour staff and volunteer workers/local community people – where there appears a need for:
 - A different blend of workers
 - People with new/different skills and expertise
 - More people to help control visitors and monitor impacts
- Altering timing of tours/activities – in terms of:
 - Seasons and/or dates for tours/activities
 - Frequencies of tours/activities
 - Arrival and departure times
 - Start and finish times for activities
 - Keeping the same activities but varying the sequence of things
- Adjusting the size and/or composition of tourists and visitors – such that, for example:
 - Group numbers/participant numbers are reduced
 - Babies/young people are prohibited
 - Local sensitivities regarding age and gender are respected
- Limiting the locations tourists can enter – when they are physically in the local community, so that, perhaps:
 - Certain houses or buildings are 'off limits'
 - Prescribed walking routes must be adhered to
 - Time limits are applied to the length of time to be spent in nominated locations
 - Nominated activities are banned in prescribed areas
- Reducing or increasing participation of the local community and the roles they play within activities – which can mean:
 - Local people may be employed as part of the crew/team for a tour in positions such as food preparation and cooking, food and beverage service, entertainment, local guides, presenters of interpretive activities
 - External workers are brought in to replace positions previously filled by local people
- Revising required Code of Conduct that will be communicated to visitors prior to their engagement with the local community – with common changes being made to topics addressing:
 - Dress
 - Behaviour
 - Respect for communities
 - Language used
 - Local customs to be observed



- Increasing the amount and/or type of resources allocated to the operation – there is commonly never a need to *reduce* the amount or type of resources committed to an initiative, but there can be a need to:
 - Employ more staff
 - Use different staff – and/or provide nominated training to staff
 - Pay local communities more money
 - Acquire and use more physical items
- Changing the supporting/underpinning infrastructure – in that there can be a need to:
 - Create more tracks roads
 - Upgrade, grade or seal tracks
 - Erect more buildings
 - Construct additional landing areas for water craft and aircraft
 - Build toilets, camp sites, kitchen and dining facilities, accommodation and other support structures
- Changing the monitoring protocols for nominated issues/topics – which can involve:
 - Adding new technologies/metering to monitor new topics/environmental concerns
 - Taking readings at more frequent intervals
 - Obtaining readings/monitoring data from different sites
- Changing the delivery method for information – and, as necessary:
 - Using a more technology-reliant option rather than, say, a human to provide a commentary/information
 - Allowing (for example) self-discovery to replace lectures, displays and presentations.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from the previous Work Project.

4.1 For the minimal impact tourism initiative identified in Work Project 1.1 evaluate the proposal providing evidence you have:

- Collected objective environmental data
 - Solicited feedback from the local community and staff
 - Collaborated with local authorities to manage local environmental and social issues caused by, or related to, the minimal impact activity/operation
 - Modified previous plans on the basis of valid data obtained.
-

Summary

Evaluate minimal impact operations

When evaluating minimal impact operations:

- Make sure the data identified as being gathered is in fact captured and recorded
- Involve stakeholders
- Use objective and subjective as required to evaluate the initiative
- Solicit feedback from those involved – staff, tourists, local communities, other stakeholders
- Conduct evaluations and manipulate data with reference to established criteria and parameters
- Use external consultants/professionals where necessary
- Make decisions based on actual data
- Share and/or publish the data and findings
- Work cooperatively with local communities to address their concerns
- Adjust plans to reflect the findings of the evaluation.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Note: all Recommended Reading is sourced from 'Trove: National Library of Australia' at <http://trove.nla.gov.au/>.

2015. *Tourism and leisure: Current issues and perspectives of development*, SpringerGabler, Wiesbaden

Alampay, Ramon Benedicto A & Philippine APEC Study Center Network & Philippine Institute for Development Studies 2005, *Sustainable tourism: challenges for the Philippines*, Philippine APEC Study Center Network, Makati City, Philippines

Brebbia, C. A & Pineda, F. D & WIT Press 2012, *Sustainable Tourism. Vol. 5*, WIT Press, Billerica: WIT Press [Distributor], Ashurst

Buckley, Ralf 2009-06-18, *Ecotourism: Principles and Practices*, CABI

Chon, Kaye Sung & Hsu, Cathy H 2012, *Casino Industry in Asia Pacific Development, Operation, and Impact*, Taylor and Francis, Hoboken

Cohen, Scott A., (editor.) & Higham, James E. S., (editor.) & Peeters, Paul, (editor.) & Gössling, Stephan, (editor.) 2014, *Understanding and governing sustainable tourism mobility: psychological and behavioural approaches*, New York Routledge

Dredge, Dianne & Macbeth, Jim & Carson, Dean & Beaumont, Narelle & Northcote, Jeremy et al. 2007-02-13, *Achieving Sustainable Local Tourism Management*, CRC for Sustainable Tourism

Edgell, David L 2006, *Managing sustainable tourism: a legacy for the future*, The Haworth Hospitality Press, New York

Gössling, Stefan, (editor of compilation.) & Hall, Colin Michael, 1961-, (editor of compilation) & Scott, Daniel, 1969-, (editor of compilation) 2015, *The Routledge handbook of tourism and sustainability*, Abingdon, Oxon New York, NY Routledge

International Conference on Sustainable Tourism (1st: 2004) & Brebbia, C. A & Pineda, F. D 2004, *Sustainable tourism*, WIT Press, Southampton

Marvell, Alan & Watkins, Claire & Geographical Association 2005, *Sustainable tourism*, Geographical Association, Sheffield [England]

Redclift, M. R, (editor of compilation.) & Springett, Delyse 2015, *Routledge international handbook of sustainable development*, Abingdon, Oxon New York, NY Routledge

Sofield, Trevor Harvey Boyd & Cooperative Research Centre for Sustainable Tourism 2005, *Sustainable tourism - eliminating poverty (ST~EP) an overview*, Sustainable Tourism CRC, Gold Coast, Qld

Solway, Andrew 2009, *Sustainable tourism*, Arcturus Pub, Mankato, Minn.

Trainee evaluation sheet

Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Plan, trial and implement minimal impact operations

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Plan minimal impact operations			
1.1	Identify the proposed activity/operation to be conducted	☐	☐
1.2	Identify the location in which the identified activity/operation is proposed to be conducted	☐	☐
1.3	Research the factors that may be impacted by the proposed activity	☐	☐
1.4	Research the compliance requirements that apply to the proposed activity/operation and location	☐	☐
1.5	Develop a plan that details the experiences and activities to be implemented	☐	☐
Element 2: Trial minimal impact operations			
2.1	Organise for the trial to be conducted	☐	☐
2.2	Conduct the trial operation as planned	☐	☐
2.3	Monitor the impacts of the trial	☐	☐
2.4	Evaluate the information generated by the trial	☐	☐
2.5	Utilise the information from the trial to modify previous plans so as to minimise negative effects and maximise positive impacts	☐	☐
Element 3: Implement minimal impact operations			
3.1	Apply revised plans to the practical application of minimal impact tourism activities/operations	☐	☐
3.2	Conduct the activity/operation in such a way that encourages others to engage in minimal impact actions	☐	☐
3.3	Implement ongoing monitoring protocols	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 4: Evaluate minimal impact operations			
4.1	Collect objective environmental data	☐	☐
4.2	Solicit feedback from the local community and staff	☐	☐
4.3	Collaborate with local authorities to manage local environmental and social issues caused by, or related to, the minimal impact activity/operation	☐	☐
4.4	Modify previous plans on the basis of valid data obtained	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

